MERRY CHRISTMAS

EPISODE 1

1. EXT. TRAIN STATION - DAY

FARRA EWING (47, female), DEMI (27, female, one of Farra's employees) and 5 other employees, some wear Santa hats, red nose reindeer makeup, and some carry a jingle bell or a speaker playing Christmas carols, some are holding a sign that says "Merry Christmas".

FEMALE EMPLOYEE
(eager)
This is gonna be the peak of my Christmas! I can't believe I get to meet Riley Diaz today!

DEMI GARCIA, in a short Christmas-style red dress, agrees along in excitement.

DEMI
Yes! Mr. Diaz! Our auto plant investor and the chairman of the Walton Group! And I heard he's super cute! I can't wait to meet him and wish him a Merry Christmas!

FARRA EWING, in a red skirt and black blazer, turns to her employees, slightly anxious.

FARRA
Alright, everyone, check the time. Mr. Diaz should be here any minute. Let's make sure we look our best!

The employees quickly fix their hair and straighten their clothes. Demi and the other female employee exchange a quick look, checking each other‘s makeup. Two LUXURY CARS pull up. Bodyguards form a neat line along the car door. One opens the door of the second car.

SLOW MOTION: RILEY DIAZ, dressed in a sleek suit with a candy cane pin on his lapel, confidence written all over his face and every movement, steps out the car. Demi and the employees’ eyes widen in awe.

DEMI
Lord save me. He's young, rich, and so handsome... He's just perfect!

FARRA
(excited)
Mr. Diaz!

Farra leads the group to greet him. The bells jingle as the employees rush forward. Two excited employees spray confetti over Riley.

Everyone welcomes and wishes him a merry Christmas. Riley raises a hand to shield his face against the confetti, brushing it off with a small smile.

RILEY
Whoa, whoa! You guys came prepared!

Farra steps forward to shake his hand, beaming.

FARRA
Merry Christmas, Mr. Riley! It’s an honor to have you back in Ravenham. We've prepared a welcome dinner for you tonight!

RILEY
You're too kind, Farra. I just had a meeting with the governor, and now I need to head to my wife's place for Christmas lunch, so I can't talk long.

FARRA
Oh we definitely understand, sir! Just before you go, please accept these Christmas gifts we've prepared for you.

The bodyguards present the gifts.

FARRA
Royal craftsman-made diamond brooch, vintage wine from Hall's Vineyard, and a few exquisite porcelain pieces!

RILEY
(surprised)
Wow! I didn't have time to pick out anything for my wife's family, and you've just saved me the trouble.

He takes out his phone, types and sends a text message.

RILEY
By the way, my wife works at the auto plant. I just sent you her info. Can you take care of it?

FARRA
No problem, sir.

Demi is in a daze mesmerized by Riley. Farra checks her phone, shocked, as she reads the message.

FARRA (VOICE OVER)
His wife is Caroline Baker?

They both watch Riley as he walks away, talking into his phone.

RILEY
(into phone)
Oh, and Draven doesn't like crowds. I should send the bodyguards back.

2. EXT. BAKER HOUSE - DAY

Riley approaches the door with gifts in hand as a car pulls up. CAROLINE BAKER(27) and ANDREW SMITH(25) step out.

RILEY
Caroline?

Caroline, caught off guard for a moment, then smiles, excited.

CAROLINE
Riley? You're back!

RILEY
Got me a slow year, so I'm able to come back and spend Christmas with you!
(turns to Andrew)
Who's this?

Andrew walks over to Caroline's side, sporting a smug smile. DORIS CLARK (50s, Caroline's mother) steps out of the house.

DORIS
(disdainfully)
Oh, look who's back. Finally went bankrupt? Good, hurry up, you and Caroline can finally get a divorce!

Riley frowns, caught off guard.

EPISODE 2

3. EXT. BAKER HOUSE - DAY

RILEY
(resigned)
Doris, long time no see. Merry Christmas!

Doris takes out the divorce papers.

DORIS
Enough chit-chat. Here are the divorce papers. Sign them.

Caroline, annoyed, takes the papers.

CAROLINE
Mom, Riley came all the way here to spend Christmas with us. You really have to bring this up now?

DORIS
(angry)
Spend Christmas with us? We don't need his company! We'd all be happier without him around.

RILEY
Doris!

CAROLINE
Enough, Doris! Stop being so mean to him!
(turns to Riley)
Don't worry, Riley, I'm not divorcing you. The only reason we asked Andrew here was so that he can help us take the gifts to the Draven's.

DORIS
You're so naive! You married a loser who can't even earn a dime! You have a wealthy and handsome suitor right here, yet you're still living with this loser!

RILEY
(frowns)
A suitor?

Doris grabs Andrew over to her side, and looks at him with pride.

DORIS
Andrew here is the R&D director at Ravenham Auto Plant, and his father is the deputy plant manager. If it weren't for you, Caroline would have married him and become a rich wife by now!

ANDREW
(smug)
Come on, Doris. I know you're right, but let's not be too hard on the poor guy.

Andrew reaches to put his arm around Caroline's shoulder. Caroline flinches and quickly pulls away. Andrew's expression darkens slightly. Riley gives Andrew a cold stare.

ANDREW
What's wrong, boy? Got a problem with me?

RILEY
(coldly)
I just want you to stay away from my wife. And as for "*poor*", do you two know what you're talking about?

DORIS
What else would you be? You're so broke you can't even afford a car! And now you're telling Andrew to keep his distance from Caroline?

CAROLINE
Mom! Please, just stop talking!

DORIS
Why should I? I'm only speaking the truth! Riley, look at Andrew's car. You'll never own something like that in your life!

Riley looks at Andrew's car parked along the street.

RILEY
(haunty)
You're right. I'll never have a car like that.

Andrew's face lights up with pride.

DORIS
Oh, so you do know your place. I was thinking you might rent something ridiculous just to impress Caroline.

Riley's eyes move from the car to the two of them.

RILEY
That Porsche is so cheap, it didn't even make it to the last year's international auto expo. So you're tight, I'll never buy one of those.

Doris and Andrew are stunned.

EPISODE 3

4. EXT. BAKER HOUSE - DAY

DORIS
Ha! Riley, even your jokes are terrible! You really think you can buy one? Do you have that kind of money?

ANDREW
An international auto expo? Do you even know what that is? That's where the real elites gather. You think you'd be invited?

RILEY
(casually)
Actually, yes. This was my first time attending the thing. They've been asking me to come for years, but I was always too busy.

ANDREW
Oh, they have been asking you for years, and you turned them down? Let me guess, did the governor also invite you to his party?

RILEY
You mean Henry? I didn't hear about any party.

DORIS
Unbelievable! He's such a clown!

CAROLINE
Riley, come on. Time to... stop with these fairy tales, don't you think?

RILEY
(sighs)
Caroline, there are things you don't know yet. I'll explain it all to you later.

ANDREW
Caroline, the chairman of the Wharton Group just arrived in Ravenham. I need to get back and help my dad prepare the welcome dinner. I don't have time to listen to this clown. I'll see you later at our Christmas lunch.

Andrew gets into his car and drives off. Doris glares at Riley.

DORIS
This is all your fault! Now Andrew's upset! Just let Caroline be with Andrew already!

CAROLINE
Mom, that's enough. Let's go inside. Cornell is still waiting for us.

Doris storms angrily into the house. Caroline turns to Riley with a reassuring smile.

CAROLINE
Riley, mom's pretty hot-tempered. Please don't take it to heart. You know I'll always be on your side.

Riley holds onto her hand gratefully.

RILEY
Babe, you're the one who waited for me for three whole years. And I will be forever grateful. Just know that wherever you are, that's where I'll be.

Riley kisses on her hand, then they embrace, quietly sharing a moment.

CAROLINE
(choking up)
I've missed you so much. I'm so glad you're back.

Riley kisses Caroline. Her phone rings. Caroline gestures at the phone, and Riley smiles and gives her an "OK" hand gesture.

CAROLINE
(into phone)
Hello? Demi?

DEMI (VOICE OVER)
Oh my God, Caroline! You'll never guess happened! I just saw the chairman of the Wharton Group—he's so young, rich, and *sooo* handsome! It was like...I fell in love at first sight!

EPISODE 4

Riley and Caroline stand outside the house. Riley smiles warmly at Caroline, who waves her phone at Riley.

CAROLINE
(whispering)
My good friend, Demi, the shining star of the Ravenham Auto Plant, I'll introduce you next time. You go ahead inside, I'll catch up in a minute.

RILEY
Alright.

Caroline puts the phone back to her ear, and smiles.

CAROLINE
(into phone)
Wow! He was *that* charming, huh?

DEMI (VOICE OVER)
He's totally my type! Oh, by the way, Caroline, I heard your husband's back. How's he doing after all those years away?

CAROLINE
(slightly let down)
Alright I guess.
(uplifting)
But that's okay, we're still living our best lives!

DEMI (VOICE OVER)
Ha. Caroline Baker, always the optimist. Later, you're gonna help me pick out a sizzling dress. I need to capture our young hot chairman at the welcome party!

CAROLINE
(laughs)
You got it, girl. Good luck!

Caroline hangs up then runs to catch up with Riley. He takes her hand, they exchange a warm smile, and enter the house together.

5. INT. BAKER HOUSE - DAY

Riley and Caroline walk in. HEIDI(30, Caroline's sister), NICK(30, Caroline's brother-in-law), CORNELL(52, Caroline's dad), Doris are seated on the couch.

HEIDI
Hey, Caroline, your long-lost husband finally made it back?

CAROLINE
(frowning)
Riley was just working out of town.

HEIDI
Good to know. I was afraid we'd see him on the news for robbing a bank and getting arrested.

RILEY
That's never gonna happen, Heidi.

NICK
Alright, alright, Heidi's just messing around. Riley, are those gifts for us?

RILEY
(smiles)
Yes, Nick, pick whatever you like.

Riley opens the gifts he brought.

HEIDI
(disdainful)
This is it?

Riley is momentarily taken aback. Heidi steps forward and starts poking at the gifts.

HEIDI
Looks like plastic brooches, some wine from a fake vineyard, and cheap ceramics that wouldn't even sell for ten bucks?

Heidi turns to Caroline.

HEIDI
Aye, Caroline, you sure your man's not playing some joke on us?

EPISODE 5

Riley and Caroline are surrounded by Doris, Cornell, Nick, and Heidi.

CAROLINE
(resigned)
Heidi, you know Riley's been through a lot. I'm sure he handpicked these!

RILEY
No, Caroline, these are pretty valuable, especially the wine! That's a rare collection from Freya Vineyard!

DORIS
Cut the crap! Freya Vineyard is top-notch, and this label clearly says it's from Hall's Vineyard!

HEIDI
Never heard of Hall's Vineyard! Probably some roadside dump! Might not even be safe to drink!

RILEY
(frowning)
Hall's Vineyard was its old name a century ago. This is their last rare batch. Even money won't buy another one of these!

Cornell, getting impatient, gets up.

CORNELL
Stop lying, Riley. I've been drinking wine for years, and I've never heard of Freya having another name! You're just making things up!

RILEY
That just means you don't know enough about wine, Cornell.

CAROLINE
Alright, Riley, enough! Even if these are just simple gifts, it's fine! We appreciate them!

RILEY
But Caroline…

HEIDI
Let's just use the wine for cooking, and pawn the brooches and ceramics. There's a thing going on at Kesso Trading where junks like these can sell for ten bucks.

NICK
Sounds like a plan. With that money, Riley, you might actually turn a profit on this trash. Not a bad deal if you ask me!

DORIS
Heidi, you're still the brain of this family!

RILEY
I'm at a loss for words to describe your ignorance, ladies and gentlemen. Mr. Draven, the former leader of the auto plant, is well-versed enough to recognize the value of these items…

HEIDI
You clown, are you insulting us?

RILEY
(cold)
No, I'm just stating something that is about to happen. Draven will make you look like idiots, and you will be crying in front of me saying how sorry you are.

EPISODE 6

Nick takes a few steps toward Riley, staring at him.

NICK
What's your problem, man?

HEIDI
You think we're too dumb to realize how precious your little gifts are? I knew you were broke, but didn't know how big of a loser you are!

RILEY
Actually, I'm not broke at all.

CAROLINE
Please stop, Riley's had a tough time. We're family. Who cares about how cheap or expensive are some Christmas gifts? It's all about being together!

HEIDI
Caroline, you're hopeless!

Caroline sighs and pulls Riley down to sit on the couch. Suddenly, MIKE(7, Heidi's son) comes running in the room, crying. Heidi swoops him up in a hurry, soothing him.

HEIDI
Mike? Sweetie, what's wrong?

MIKE
Mom! My favorite toy car is broken!

HEIDI
Oh no, your favorite one? Don't worry, Mike, we'll get a new one!

MIKE
But I want *that* car!

NICK
Stop crying, Mike. They stopped making that toy car for years. You need to learn to be a little man and not cry over some broken toys!

MIKE
No! I want my car!

DORIS
Nick, it's Christmas. Don't be so hard on him!

NICK
But Doris, that toy only came with real car purchases. There's nothing I can do!

DORIS
(uncertain)
Andrew's dad is the deputy director at the auto plant. Caroline, you could ask Andrew. Maybe he could get Mike another one!

HEIDI
Great idea, Doris! Please, Caroline, help us out!

RILEY
No, no, no. That man seems a bit too interested in Caroline. As her husband, I think my wife should keep her distance from him.

CAROLINE
Riley, I don't mind asking him, if it's just to help Mike.

RILEY
(warm)
No need for you to go through the trouble, babe. I'll get Mike a new one myself.

EPISODE 7

Everyone looks suspiciously at Riley.

CAROLINE
Really?

RILEY
(smiles)
Yes, Mike can get a new car and the toy model that comes with it. Consider it my Christmas gift to him.

Everyone pauses, then bursts out laughing.

HEIDI
Caroline, your husband is a riot! Without him, I'd have missed out on so many laughs today!

NICK
Buy a real car to get the toy. How come we didn't think of that?

RILEY
Mike, come here!

Mike runs over to Riley, who writes a note, stamps it, and hands it to Mike.

RILEY
Go ahead, Mike, pick out any car you like. The car and the toy will be my Christmas gift to you!

MIKE
Awesome!

Mike takes the note and runs out. Heidi chases after him.

HEIDI
Wait. Mike! Mike!
(turns angrily to Riley)
You lying jerk! Mike is gonna be devastated!

CAROLINE
Riley! He's just a kid!

DORIS
(pissed)
I told you not to marry him!

Doris angrily slams divorce papers on the table.

DORIS
You piece of trash, divorce my Caroline right now, and get out of our house!

Cornell can barely contain his anger.

CORNELL
Doris, it's Christmas. Let's all stay calm. How about this, Riley? I got an old friend, Bob, he's the factory deputy director. Come with me, and I'll ask him to set you up with a decent job.

RILEY
(laughs bitterly)
Cornell, I appreciate you trying to help, but Bob can't get me the kind of job I need.

CORNELL
What kind of job *do* you want? Chairman of the Wharton Group? Grow up, Riley. Take whatever you can get! It's settled. After dinner, you and I are going to see Bob.

EPISODE 8

6. EXT. AUTO PLANT - DAY

Mike is pacing outside, holding the note in his hand, peeking inside nervously. EAMON(late 30s) approaches him.

EAMON
Hey kid, what are you doing here? Shouldn't you be home for Christmas?

MIKE
Are you the man who works at the auto plant?

Eamon is taken aback for a moment.

EAMON
Yeah, I am. I'm the head of the inspection department. Just doing a final check on some cars before I leave. But you, kid, you should be at home.

Mike eagerly hands Eamon the note.

MIKE
(excited)
My uncle gave me this note. He said I can pick out a car and get the toy that comes with it!

Eamon sighs and takes the note, ready to dismiss it.

EAMON
Oh boy, another one of those silly pranks. I bet this is just as useless...

Eamon glances at the note, and suddenly, his expression changes.

EAMON
Oh my God... Is this real? This has the Wharton Group Chairman's seal on it?

MIKE
Mister, can I go in and pick a car now?

Eamon, still in shock, reexamines the note, then looks at Mike in disbelief.

EAMON
Uh... yes. Yes, of course. Please, follow me...*sir*.

7. INT. BAKER HOUSE - DAY

Riley, Caroline, Doris, Cornell, Nick, and Heidi are in the living room.

CORNELL
Riley! What's the deal here? I try to help you get a job, and you just throw it back in my face?

DORIS
Someone like you should show some respect to Bob, and not act like some smart-ass!

HEIDI
Riley, I'm warning you! If you care more about your so called dignity than getting a job, then you really are the biggest fool in the world!

Mike bursts in, waving a toy, thrilled.

MIKE
Nick! Heidi! Look!

Everyone looks at him, surprised.

HEIDI
Did you really get the same toy?

MIKE
And a car! Mr. Eamon drove it over for me!

HEIDI
A- a car?

Riley smiles as everyone heads outside, where Eamon is just parking the car at the front door. He steps out of the car.

EAMON
Is this spot okay, little buddy?

MIKE
Perfect! Thanks, mister!

Eamon smiles, waves, then leaves on foot. Everyone else just stares at the luxury car in shock and exchange stunned glances.

EPISODE 9

8. INT. BECK HOUSE - DAY

Everyone is gathered inside, still processing what just happened. Heidi mutters to herself.

HEIDI
That...that's a limited edition Phantom. It's at least in the eight-figure range. Am I dreaming?

NICK
This is real, right? I can't believe Riley actually managed to get a car like this!

Doris and Caroline both turn to Riley, shocked. Riley simply smiles.

DORIS
(shocked, turning to Mike)
This is ridiculous! Mike, how did you get that car?

Mike waves the note with excitement.

MIKE
I just gave Mr. Eamon this note, like this, and he took me to see the cars! He even said the seal on it was really important!

NICK
Seal? What seal?

Nick takes the note and examines it closely. After a moment, a realization hits him.

NICK
(furious)
I get it now! I know how Mike got that car, and I know exactly what kind of dirty trick Riley was pulling!

HEIDI
(confused)
What are you talking about?

NICK
He's a damn fraud, that's what he is!

CAROLINE
Nick, what are you saying? If you know something, just tell us!

NICK
This note got the toy because of the seal on it!
(pointing at Riley)
You forged the Wharton Group's executive seal, didn't you? You tricked that guy into giving Mike the car!

HEIDI
So that's it! You can just pull out a fake seal like that. Clearly, you've done this before! You're a con artist!

DORIS
God, you're nothing but trash!

CAROLINE
Wait! Wait! Maybe this is just a huge misunderstanding!

Riley stands there, stunned.

EPISODE 10

Everyone is still in the living room, the tension thick in the air.

DORIS
(angry)
Caroline! Don't you get it? Your husband Riley, he is a fraud!

CAROLINE
No, I do *not* believe Riley would do something like that!

RILEY
(sighs)
You're right, Caroline, you have to trust me. Doris, I hate to say this but you've got it all wrong.

HEIDI
Wrong? What could we possibly be wrong about? Explain that damn seal!

RILEY
That is because I'm actually...

ANDREW (OFF SCREEN)
Caroline! I brought Christmas gifts!

Caroline looks towards the door as Doris and Cornell exchange looks.

DORIS
It's Andrew! He's finished with work and came to see Caroline!

CORNELL
We'll deal with Riley's shit later. Let's not embarrass ourselves in front of Andrew!

Everyone heads to the door to greet Andrew, who enters with a smile, carrying gift bags.

DORIS
Andrew! So happy you're here to spend Christmas with us!

ANDREW
I've got some good news for you, Doris. I heard that Farra, the plant manager, is coming by to wish you all a Merry Christmas too! You're truly blessed. Everyone's showing you so much love!

CAROLINE
(puts on a happy face)
Oh, that's wonderful!

DRAVEN BAKER(74) steps out of a room, smiling.

DRAVEN
It sure is lively out there. I cut my massage session short just to come join you.

DORIS
(excited)
Draven! Perfect timing. This is Andrew, the son of the deputy director at Ravenham Auto Plant. He and Caroline are kind of a special thing and he's here to spend Christmas with us!

DRAVEN
(laughing)
Well, isn't he a handsome young man!

Andrew takes out a gift box.

ANDREW
Mr. Draven, I've brought you a present. It's a diamond watch and a set of fine wines from the Freya Vineyard.

DRAVEN
Andrew, how did you know? Freya wines are my absolute favorite!

DORIS
(proud)
Andrew always has the most thoughtful gifts
(casts a disdainful look at Riley)
Unlike a certain someone who only brings trash to ruin everyone's mood!

RILEY
Doris, whether you believe me or not, I have to say, a truckload of his stuff can't even cover half of what I got.

EPISODE 11

DORIS
You idiot, we've seen right through all your junk! And you're still trying to feed us this crap?

ANDREW
(mocking)
Riley, man, you're hilarious. A broke guy like you trying to act rich in front of me? I don't even know what to say.

RILEY
I'm curious, what exactly makes you so confident?

ANDREW
Look at this moron! My father is the Vice President of Ravenham Motors, and I'm the head of R&D! That factory is the lifeline of this town. Everyone respects us!

RILEY
(calm)
Got it.

ANDREW
You think this is funny? You're not gonna be laughing for long!

DORIS
Riley, you've disrespected Andrew enough! Apologize now, or nobody will be able to save you!

RILEY
(cold)
I don't think I need anybody to save me, Doris. If you really care about him, make *him* apologize, to *me*.

DORIS
(enraged)
Are you insane? What the hell are you saying?

NICK
You've got a death wish disrespecting Andrew!

Caroline looks anxious. Andrew's face darkens as he stands and approaches Riley.

ANDREW
You got some nerve. I think it's time you learn a lesson. Mess with the wrong guy, you pay the price!

Andrew swings a punch at Riley's face. Caroline screams.

CAROLINE
No! Riley!

Riley catches Andrew's fist, his expression cold. Andrew struggles, trying to pull free, but Riley holds his fist tightly, forces Andrew back, pressing him hard against the wall. Riley twists his wrist outward. Andrew gasps in pain.

RILEY
If you don't want you and your daddy kicked out of Ravenham Motors, you'd better get on your knees and apologize. Right now.

EPISODE 12

ANDREW
You piece of shit! I'll kill you!

HEIDI
Let go of him! You nut case!

DORIS
You're dead meat now!

CAROLINE
(desperate)
No, no, Andrew, please forgive Riley. Don't hurt him. He doesn't mean any disrespect. Riley, let him go.

Riley glances at Caroline, then lets go of Andrew.

ANDREW
That's it. I'm calling my security right now. They'll teach you a lesson!

CAROLINE
No!

DRAVEN
(impatient)
Enough! We're here to spend Christmas together. Let's eat. Anyone not interested can leave.

Everyone quiets down, though Andrew, Doris, and the others still look upset.

CAROLINE
Grandpa's right. Why don't we all calm down. It was just a misunderstanding. Let's go.

Andrew and the others, still fuming, follow Draven to the dining room. Caroline sighs in relief and takes Riley's hand.

CAROLINE
Come on, Riley, you need to stop saying crazy things like that. You know how much I worry about you!

RILEY
Don't worry, darling. I'll be fine.

CAROLINE
Just be careful, Riley.

Riley smiles, nodding, and they head to the dining room together.

9. INT. BAKER HOUSE - DINING ROOM - DAY

The table is laden with food. The group sits down as Andrew pours a glass of wine and hands it to Draven.

ANDREW
Draven, try this wine. It's a top-tier vintage from Freya Vineyard. I picked it out just for you.

Drake takes the glass with a smile, sips it.

DRAVEN
This is some excellent wine!

NICK
Andrew's the best! Each bottle from Freya Vineyard costs hundreds of thousands.

Draven keeps sipping, impressed.

DRAVEN
This is indeed a rare treat! Thank you for sharing it with us, Andrew.

Andrew waves it off, looking smug, then reaches for Caroline's hand. She pulls away. Andrew's expression darkens, and he looks at Riley with arrogance. Riley remains cold.

DRAVEN
(laughing)
Come on, everyone, let's eat!

The group starts eating. Draven cuts into his food and takes a bite, then frowns.

DRAVEN
Oh, my God, this taste…

HEIDI
Drake, what's wrong?

DRAVEN
Did you add something to this sauce?

HEIDI
Just some of the cheap wine Riley brought. Why?

Draven slams his fist down on the table, outraged.

DRAVEN
Are you insane?! Do you realize what you have done!

EPISODE 13

HEIDI
Grandpa, what the hell is going on?

NICK
Is there something wrong with the wine?

HEIDI
I knew it! We should've just tossed that cheap crap! We might get food poisoning from it!

She reaches for the sauce.

DRAVEN
Stop!

Heidi freezes. Draven pushes her aside, grabs the bowl with the sauce in it, smells it, then dips his pinkie in it and tastes the finger tip.

DRAKE
(angry)
I knew it. This is a rare vintage from Freya Vinyard! I had it twenty years ago at the Governor's house! The taste is unforgettable! I would recognize it anywhere!

Everyone is stunned. Riley smirks and shakes his head.

DORIS
(shocked)
How is that possible?
(grabs the bottle)
But Draven, this bottle says it's from Hall Vineyard, not Freya!

DRAKE
That was the name of Freya Vineyard a hundred years ago!
(MORE)

DRAKE (CONT'D)
This is their century-old vintage! One bottle is worth a million dollars! Even the President would struggle to get access to it, and you used it to cook beef!

DORIS
What? A m- million dollars?

HEIDI
Wait a second, then what about the other stuff Riley brought?

DRAVEN
What? Riley gave you more? Bring them to me, now!

Heidi hurriedly brings over the other gifts.

HEIDI
(nervous)
I..um.. may have already signed an electronic agreement with the auction house. They're coming tomorrow to collect everything.

Draven picks up a brooch and a piece of porcelain, examines them closely, then takes a step back in shock. Caroline hurries over to steady him.

CAROLINA
Grandpa!

DRAVEN
This brooch is made of pure diamonds. Just that alone makes it priceless. And the craftsmanship... it's definitely a masterpiece! And this porcelain... I've only seen it at a private collection of a corporate CEO! This belongs in a museum!
(turns to Heidi)
Riley gave you all of this?

Everyone looks at Riley in shock.

DRAVEN
You said you sold these to the auction house. How much did you sell them for?

HEIDI
Ten dollars... each...

DRAVEN
You idiot! Are you out of your mind? You sold items worth millions for a few bucks! God, you fool!

Everyone looks at each other in panic, then all turn to Riley, who stands with his hands behind his back, a look of pride and confidence on his face.

EPISODE 14

Draven puts a hand to his head, slightly weak.

DRAVEN
Oh, my head…

Caroline, worried, rushes to support him.

DRAVEN
Caroline, could you help me to my room? I'm feeling really dizzy.

CAROLINE
Of course, grandpa.

Doris stares at the gifts in panic.

DORIS
How is this possible? Riley brought all of this...how could he afford such expensive gifts?

RILEY
There's nothing hard about it, Doris. Maybe you've finally started to know me.

DORIS
Ugh, even if you somehow got all this stuff, your smart mouth still makes me sick.

NICK
I still don't believe you could afford them. How did you get them? Wait... did you steal them?

Caroline comes back, and catches Nick asking this.

CAROLINE
Nick! How can you say that? That's so insulting!

NICK
But Caroline...

Riley grabs Caroline and pulls her in close.

RILEY
Nick, stop slandering me with baseless accusations before you really piss me off!

ANDREW
Hold on! Everyone, I just realized something!

Everyone turns to Andrew.

ANDREW
That brooch looks real familiar. Our factory manager at Ravenham Motors, Farra, she had a brooch just like that, and she was gonna have Joseph give it to the chairman of the Wharton Group!

Everyone is taken aback.

NICK
So... what are you saying?

ANDREW
Give me that brooch. I'm sending a picture to Joseph.

Heidi hands the brooch to Andrew, who takes a photo with his phone. Everyone watches him, waiting.

ANDREW
This is the one!

Andrew raises the brooch, showing his phone.

ANDREW
(eager)
This is the brooch that Farra had prepared! Riley, you stole the gift meant for the chairman of Wharton Group!?

HEIDI
Oh, God, you scum! I should've known!

DORIS
I can't believe you'd do this! You idiot! If Farra finds out, we're all done for!

NICK
(angry)
You filthy thief! You've put us all in trouble. My god, why don't you fucking die already!

EPISODE 15

RILEY
Wait! You've got it all wrong!

ANDREW
I've sent the photo to Joseph. The brooch is definitely the one Farra had prepared, no doubt about it!

DORIS
Caroline, you're still defending him? My poor girl, this filthy man has been lying to you! He's nothing but trash!

RILEY
Enough! I'm done with your stupidity! I just haven't had the chance to tell you who I really am, but I didn't expect you to expose yourselves like this!

HEIDI
Still committing to the act,huh? Who are you supposed to be? The chairman of Wharton Group?

Caroline looks at Riley in disbelief, then suddenly slaps him across the face.

CAROLINE
You stole, didn't you?

RILEY
Caroline?

CAROLINE
How else could you possibly get these? Riley, you don't have money, and I've never cared about that. But I can't stand the thought of you stealing and lying! Riley, tell me this isn't true!

RILEY
Wait, Caroline, how could you believe their lies——

Caroline, teary-eyed, shakes her head in disappointment.

CAROLINE
Riley, if you won't tell me the truth, how am I supposed to help you? We could face anything together, but if you can’t be honest with me, then... then after Christmas, we'll get a divorce!

Riley reaches for her hand and holds it tightly in his.

RILEY
Caroline! Please believe me, these were Farra's gifts to me. I didn't steal anything! I came to tell you the truth about who I really am!

EPISODE 16

CAROLINE
(tired)
Riley, you keep talking nonsense instead of telling me what's really going on. How can you expect me to believe you?

RILEY
But I *am* telling the truth, Caroline!

The doorbell rings. Farra's voice is heard through the door.

FARRA (OFF SCREEN)
Hi! It's Farra!

Everyone turns to the door, shocked.

CAROLINE
Farra Ewing? She's here?

DORIS
Oh no! We can't let Ms. Ewing see this thief with those gifts! We'll never be able to explain it! Quick, get him out of here! Take him through the back door!

Nick and Cornell grab Riley and drag him to the back.

RILEY
Caroline! You have to trust me!
(turns to Nick and Cornell)
You idiots, let go of me! When you find out the truth, you'll be begging for forgiveness!

NICK
Shut up! Let's go!

CAROLINE
No!

RILEY
Don't worry, Caroline. I'll be back soon.

Nick and Cornell drag Riley out. Heidi goes to open the door. Farra enters with a smile, followed by her bodyguards.

HEIDI
(flattering)
Hi, Ms. Ewing! Please, come in!

FARRA
Merry Christmas, everyone!

She walks over to Caroline.

FARRA
Caroline, I have great news for you. Thanks to a very concerned gentleman, you're about to be promoted to Head of Public Relations at Ravenham Motors!

Caroline is stunned.

EPISODE 17

DORIS
(excited, warmly)
Ms. Ewing! Please, come in and have a seat!

Farra smiles as everyone gathers around her, guiding her to the sofa. Caroline sits beside her, still shocked.

CAROLINE
Ms. Ewing, this is so unexpected, I..don't know what to say. Just having you here to spend Christmas with us is an honor, and now...

Farra smiles, holding onto Caroline's hand.

FARRA
No need to be modest, Caroline. You deserve all of this. And as for the gentleman who's been looking out for you, who got you this promotion, I think you already know who that is...

DORIS
Andrew! It's Andrew!

Everyone turns to Andrew. He smiles, a bit smug, and steps forward. Fara looks slightly confused.

ANDREW
Ms. Ewing, I'm honored! I only mentioned Caroline's name and I can't believe you'd actually promote her! Thank you for your trust and support! Caroline and I won't let you down!

FARRA
No, wait....

DORIS
Andrew, thank you so much! You're the lucky star of the Baker family!

CORNELL
We're so lucky to have you looking out for Caroline, Andrew. We don't know how to thank you!

CAROLINE
Thank you, Andrew, but this makes me a little uneasy. Maybe I don't deserve this opportunity.

Farra assures her earnestly.

FARRA
No, Caroline, you're the most deserving person for this position!

CAROLINE
What?

FARRA
Actually, I've been meaning to ask, where's your husband, Mr. Riley Diaz?

Everyone is caught off guard.

EPISODE 18

CAROLINE
I'm sorry, did you just say Riley? Do you know him?

FARRA
Of course. Aw, you're so humble. You're Riley Diaz's wife, yet you've never even mentioned him.

Doris, Nick, and Heidi huddle together, whispering.

DORIS
Why is Ms. Ewing referring to Riley with such respect? What does she want with him?

NICK
She must've found out Riley stole those gifts! She's testing us!

HEIDI
Damn Riley! He's dragging us all down!

FARRA
What's going on? Is Riley not here? I thought he was coming here to have lunch with you...

DORIS
No, Ms. Ewing, you're mistaken! We don't know any Riley. Caroline's not his wife!

FARRA
What?

CAROLINE
Wait, mom, what're you talking about?

Doris pulls Caroline aside, giving her a warning look to stay quiet.

HEIDI
Yes, Ms. Ewing, Caroline doesn't know any Riley. If she has a husband, it must be Andrew!

Both Caroline and Farra are shocked. Farra frowns in disbelief.

FARRA
Andrew?

HEIDI
Exactly! Andrew is a big admirer of her, and she likes him too. If everything goes well, they'll be married soon!

DORIS
That's right! Ms. Ewing, Caroline and Andrew are such a perfect match! Especially now that Caroline will be the head of PR at the car factory!

FARRA
Oh my God, do you even know what you're saying? Riley is Caroline's husband! There's no way I'm wrong about that!

DORIS
(clenching her teeth)
You know, well, uh...

Doris and Heidi exchange uneasy looks. Doris makes up her mind and turns to Farra.

DORIS
(with unease)
We know Riley stole your Christmas gifts, so we already told Caroline to divorce him after the holidays! We just sent him to the police station! I'm sure he'll get the punishment he deserves!

Farra suddenly stands up, shocked and panicked.

FARRA
The police station? You sent him to the police station? My God!

Farra looks horrified, says nothing more, and storms out, leaving everyone behind.

EPISODE 19

10. INT. BAKER HOUSE - DAY

Doris and the others watch Farra leave in confusion.

DORIS
Ms. Fara Ewing seemed really upset. What do we do?

HEIDI
It's all because Riley stole from her! Now she hates us too!

NICK
Damn that Riley! He deserves a bullet in his head! My brother Whelan works at the police station, and I've already told him to teach that son of a bitch a lesson!

CAROLINE
Enough!

Everyone turns to Caroline, who looks disappointed and tired. She backs away, shaking her head.

CAROLINE
You shouldn't have said those things. I am Riley's wife, and I have nothing to do with Andrew!

DORIS
Caroline! We're doing this for your future. Why are you still defending that worthless husband of yours? When will you grow up?

Andrew steps in trying to wrap his arm around Caroline.

ANDREW
Yeah, Caroline, I'm a thousand times better than that loser. Why won't you accept that?

Caroline recoils from Andrew's touch, shocked.

CAROLINE
This Christmas lunch is over. I'm going to find Riley.

ANDREW
Damn it!

Caroline heads for the door. Doris and the others frown in disapproval as they watch her leave.

11. INT. POLICE STATION - DAY

Riley sits coldly at an interrogation table as Whelan throws a document in front of him.

WHELAN
Nick told me to make sure you got what's coming to you, Riley. We're practically family, so I gotta ask. How could you steal such expensive items from Ms. Farra Ewing?

RILEY
I didn't steal anything. And you're gonna regret keeping me here without knowing the facts.

WHELAN
You think I respect you because I'm being civil? You're a worthless piece of trash. Even if I beat you to death, nothing would come of it.

Whelan jabs his finger at the document.

WHELAN
Sign this confession! If you cooperate, I might let you go home for Christmas!

Riley scoffs.

RILEY
And if I refuse?

EPISODE 20

12. INT. POLICE STATION - DAY

WHELAN
You piece of shit, are you really going to make me get violent?

Whelan pulls out a gun, closing in on Riley.

WHELAN
It's Christmas, so don't blame me for not showing family loyalty! I could kill you right here and no one would give a shit.

RILEY
Whelan, I'll give you one last chance because we're family. Put the gun down, or you won't like the consequences.

WHELAN
Are you're threatening me?

He aims the gun at Riley's head. A POLICEMAN rushes in.

POLICEMAN
Whelan! We've got a problem! Outside....

Whelan kicks the policeman, angry.

WHELAN
What's the matter with you? I'm here, why are you scared shitless?

POLICEMAN
This is serious.

WHELAN
Well, spit it out then. What the hell is it?

POLICEMAN
Ms. Farra Ewing, the manager of Ravenham Motors, she's here!

WHELAN
What? Quick, get ready to give her a warm welcome!

Whelan rushes to greet her, but Farra enters with her bodyguards, looking furious.

WHELAN
Ms. Ewing! What brings you here on this fine holiday?

Farra glances at Riley, then turns to Whelan coldly.

FARRA
What are you doing?

WHELAN
(points at Riley)
This piece of trash stole the Christmas gifts you prepared for the chairman! Good thing I caught him! I was just about to get it out of him! He's been denying it, but don't worry! I'm about to teach him a lesson!

Riley chuckles, and Farra struggles to contain her anger. Whelan, obviously not reading the room, continues with his cocky and fawning tone.

WHELAN
Don't worry! He got the balls to steal from you, so I'll make sure he pays!

EPISODE 21

13. INT. POLICE STATION - DAY

Riley smirks, looking directly at Whelan.

RILEY
Whelan, dude, I applaud your effort, but you better start thinking about how you're gonna beg for mercy!

WHELAN
Still running your mouth, I can end you right here, cocksucker!

He turns to Farra with a fake smile.

WHELAN
Ms. Ewing, I'm about to teach him a lesson. It's about to get messy. Maybe you should wait outside so you don't have to see it.

Farra slaps Whelan hard across the face.

FARRA
You idiot!

Whelan holds his face, stunned.

WHELAN
Ma'am, what's that for?

FARRA
You wanna know why?
(points at Riley)
You don't even respect the chairman of the Wharton Group! You're lucky I didn't put a bullet in your head right now!

WHELAN
The ch...
(points at Riley)
Him? He's the chairman?

Riley stands tall, glaring at Whelan.

RILEY
I warned you you were gonna regret this.

Farra steps closer to Riley, bowing.

FARRA
Sir, I'm so sorry! I should've gotten here sooner. I'll make sure this is handled properly.

RILEY
It's good you were late. Otherwise I wouldn't have the chance to watch this idiot make a fool of himself.

Whelan, now panicked, falls to his knees. Two of Riley's men are closing in on him.

WHELAN
Riley—no, Mr. Diaz— Sir! Please forgive me! I was too stupid to recognize who you are! Please, for the sake of family, have mercy!

RILEY
Now you want to talk about family? You were going to shoot me.
(to Farra)
Kindly inform his family he's going away for a while. On a... business trip.

FARRA
Yes, sir.

WHELAN
Wait! Where am I going?

The two men, putting on leather gloves, one takes out a black duct tape, corner Whelan, his scream of pain echoes the room as Riley walks out without another glance.

EPISODE 22

14. EXT. POLICE STATION - DAY

Riley heads towards the exit and bumps into CODY BROWN(45).

CODY
(excited)
Riley? Riley Diaz?

Riley pauses, puzzled, then slowly recognizes him.

RILEY
Cody? You're the manager at Wharton Group. What brings you to the police station?

Cody bows slightly and respectfully

CODY
Ravenham Auto applied for a ten-million-dollar project. I'm here to assess it. Then I heard you were arrested, so I rushed over. Who had the audacity to disrespect you?

RILEY
Just a bunch of idiots! Anyway, keep an eye on the auto plant for embezzlement. I have a feeling some fools are up to no good.

CODY
Absolutely, sir! In fact, I've noticed some discrepancies in the accounts, which is why I came to investigate in person. Something tells me Bob, the deputy director, is moving funds out of the company.

RILEY
Deputy director, Bob? Cody, let's have a Christmas party at the auto plant this afternoon, and bring Bob. I'm gonna make sure those fools learn their lesson.

Cody bows with humility.

CODY
I'll take care of it.

As Cody leaves, Caroline approaches the police station, glancing across the street.

DEMI (OFF SCREEN)
(concerned)
Hey! Caroline!

Caroline turns, seeing Demi running toward her. She hesitates, then forces a smile. Riley, exiting the station, notices Caroline.

RILEY
(smiling to himself)
Caroline? She skipped Christmas lunch to come looking for me? She really does care! God, she's adorable.

He walks towards her

CAROLINE
Demi, what are you doing here? I thought you're picking out your sizzling hot dress.

Riley, not far away, waves cheerfully.

RILEY
(calling out)
Caroline! Sweetheart!

Demi grabs Caroline's hand, concerned.

DEMI
I heard your husband stole something meant for the Wharton Group chairman. I can't believe this is happening! Caroline, are you okay?

EPISODE 23

15. EXT. STREET OUTSIDE POLICE STATION - DAY

CAROLINE
(worried)
Riley and I had a fight, and now I regret it. I can't believe he'd actually steal something. There must be some misunderstanding!

DEMI
Honey, you're always so kind, always thinking of others, but I hate to see you getting fooled. Maybe your husband isn't as honest as you think.

CAROLINE
No, Demi. You don't know him like I do. He's really a good man!

Demi sighs, and pats Caroline on the shoulder.

DEMI
Caroline, I just want you to know, you deserve better. Look at the chairman of Wharton Group. He brought his wife such amazing gifts. She must be over the moon!

Caroline looks down, disheartened. Something occurs to Demi as her face lights up.

DEMI
Oh, right! What about Andrew, our chief engineer at the auto plant? He's been after you for a while. You should let him in and ditch your useless husband!

Riley crosses the street, nearly getting hit by a car. He frowns. The car squeaks to a stop. BOWEN AMOS (27) rolls down his window, furious.

BOWEN
What the hell? You tryna get killed?
(suddenly recognizes Riley)
Oh, well, if it isn't my old pal Riley!

Riley scowls, annoyed.

RILEY
Bowen? You nearly ran me over and have the nerve to yell at me? You should thank God I'm not hurt, or you'd be the one who gets killed!

BOWEN
Dammit, Riley! Sure, you got all those A's in high school, but out here, that doesn't mean squat. One call from me, and you won't know what hit you!

Riley scoffs.

RILEY
You not only refuse to apologize, but now you're acting all tough?

BOWEN
Yeah, so what? I got money and power, I've got every right to be tough! Look at you, poor and pathetic. What good did all those grades do you? Still begging for my spare change?
(thumbs his chest)
Buddy, do you even know who I am? I'm the head mechanic at Raveham Auto. I've got dozens of guys under me! You don't keep your mouth shut, and I'll have them beat you so bad you won't even see straight!

EPISODE 24

16. EXT. POLICE STATION STREET - DAY

Riley stands on the sidewalk, watching as Bowen sneers at him from inside his car.

RILEY
From a small-time thug to a big-time one. Impressive, Bowen. Should I applaud?

BOWEN
Fuck you, bitch! You're asking for it!

Borwin reaches for the door handle to get out, but his phone rings. He pauses to answer it.

BOWEN
What? A Christmas party at the factory this afternoon? Everyone's going? Even Andrew?

Riley crosses his arms, watching Bowen with amusement as he talks on the phone.

BOWEN
Perfect! I was just gonna deliver Andrew's Christmas gift. I'm hoping he'll give me the contract for the auto repair on the new project. They're applying for ten million from Wharton Group!

Bowen hangs up and looks at Riley with contempt.

BOWEN
You're lucky I got bigger fish to fry.
(MORE)

BOWEN (CONT'D)
I'm off to the Christmas party to meet the man who got me into the factory, Andrew! But next time I see you, I'll make sure you beg for mercy!

Bowen drives off, leaving Riley standing there, unimpressed.

RILEY
So working at Ravenham Auto makes you this cocky? Bowen, Andrew... The factory's really full of parasites.

He smiles to himself and continues walking, waving to Caroline.

RILEY
Caroline!

Across the street, Demi stands face-to-face with Caroline.

DEMI
(earnest)
Caroline, trust me. If you get together with Andrew, your life will be a million times better.

CAROLINE
Demi, Doris has already told me this a hundred times today. Please, don't start.

DEMI
But Caroline, I'm only thinking of you. Imagine how bad you'll feel when I become the boss's wife, and you're still stuck with that loser.

Caroline breaks out in laughter.

CAROLINE
Alright, alright. I know your boss is the best! But remember, Demi, the guy is married.

DEMI
(smug)
Who cares? Even if he is, he's a million times better than your broke, no-good, thieving husband. By the way, did you hear? The factory's hosting a Christmas party this afternoon. Maybe the boss will show up. You should meet him. He's rich, handsome... he's got the whole package!

Riley approaches them, still smiling.

EPISODE 25

17. EXT. STREET OUTSIDE POLICE STATION - DAY

Riley continues down the street when a young man bumps into him, snatching his wallet. Riley immediately grabs his arm.

RILEY
(coldly)
You've got guts stealing from me.

YOUNG MAN
What are you talking about? Let me go!

RILEY
Hand it over.

The young man jerks his arm free and tries to run, but Riley quickly catches him, snatching the wallet back. The young man escapes, stumbling down the street.

RILEY
Run all you want. The police station's right ahead. Have fun explaining yourself.

Riley checks his wallet, then puts it back in his pocket, continuing down the street.

CAROLINE
(smiles)
Alright, Demi. Even if the boss doesn't show up at the party, I'll still see him at the welcome dinner tonight.

DEMI
You're right! I'm just so hyped. I need to go pick out a dress! See you later!

Demi hurries off as Riley strides over to Caroline, who looks surprised. He takes her hand, grinning.

RILEY
Babe! I knew you were worried about me.

CAROLINE
Riley? You're out?
(touches his arm, concerned)
Are you hurt?

RILEY
No worries. Farra came by and cleared everything up with the cops. I'm free as a bird!

CAROLINE
That's good. Thank God Farra's too busy with the Christmas party to deal with you. I don't want to fight on Christmas day. But I'm not gonna be happy if this happens again.

RILEY
No problem, There won't be a next time.

He gently kisses her. She smiles lovingly at him.

CAROLINE
I just heard the factory is having a Christmas party this afternoon. Come with me.

RILEY
Sounds good.

CAROLINE
I'll grab us a cab.

She heads to the curb and Riley's phone rings. He answers.

CORNELL (VOICE OVER)
Riley, I need you to meet me so I can introduce you to Bob, the assistant manager at the factory. He's an old friend of mine. I'll ask him to give you a job.

RILEY
Cornell, actually...

CORNELL (VOICE OVER)
End of discussion. Just do it.

Cornell hangs up. Riley lowers his phone, looking resigned.

EPISODE 26

18. INT. SMITH HOUSE - DAY

BOBS SMITH (52, Andrew's dad) sits at a table, flipping through documents. He sips tea, looking impatient. His phone rings, and he answers it.

BOB
(surprised)
Cody? Hi! Oh, I'm just going over some files. I'll be at the factory soon. What? You're coming to inspect us?

CODY (VOICE OVER)
Yes, I've reviewed the proposal you submitted for the new project. I need to verify its viability before approving any funds.

BOB
No problem, sir! As it happens, we're hosting a Christmas party this afternoon! You're more than welcome to join us!

Cody hangs up. Bob lowers the phone, still excited. Andrew walks over, equally thrilled.

ANDREW
Dad, the fact that Cody called you first instead of Farrah... That says it all! The Wharton Group values you more than her!

BOB
Of course! I've been with the factory for years. Built a solid reputation! Plus, Cody's here to review this project. If the funds come through, we're looking at a billion dollars!

ANDREW
A billion! Dad, if we keep just a hundred mill for ourselves...

BOB
(pretentious)
Oh, oh, Andrew! Don't go saying things like that!
(pauses)
Ten million should be enough.

ANDREW
Awesome! Once you replace Farra as the factory manager, and I become your deputy, we'll be untouchable! No one in Ravenham will dare mess with us!

Bob chuckles arrogantly as his phone rings again. He glances at it and declines the call.

ANDREW
Who was that?

BOB
Cornell. We're old buddies, but he keeps begging me to give his son-in-law a job. How pathetic.

ANDREW
What an idiot! He still hasn't ditched that loser? He should know by now. His daughter will only be happy with me.

Bob shoots him a look.

BOB
Still haven't won her over yet?

Andrew grumbles, eyes full of resentment.

ANDREW
It's just a matter of time. Soon enough, she'll realize her husband is nothing compared to me. Dad, you get ready for Cody. I'm heading to the party.

Andrew heads out.

19. INT. AUTO FACTORY - EVENT HALL - DAY

Caroline and Riley enter the bustling event hall.

RILEY
Babe, you go on ahead. I need to make a quick call.

Caroline nods and walks further into the hall, greeting some of her friends. Riley dials his phone.

RILEY
(into phone)
Cody, I'm at the party now. Make sure you dig deep into the embezzlement going on with this factory project.

Caroline runs back to Riley, smiling.

CAROLINE
Riley! They've got Christmas fruit pies over there. Wanna go grab a slice?

She pulls Riley toward the refreshment table. Riley tucks away his phone as they head over.

Caroline hands him a piece of pie, which he takes with a smile. Bowen strides up, angry.

BOWEN
Hold it. That ain't for you, you piece of shit! It's for Andrew!

EPISODE 27

Caroline and Riley freeze, looking toward Bowen.

RILEY
What did you say?

BOWEN
You deaf? I said these pies are for Andrew. Hands off!

CAROLINE
But this is a public event. The food should be for everyone.

RILEY
I get it. You're sucking up to Andrew. But this food isn't some private property, it belongs to everyone here, for the party.

BOWEN
Shut the hell up, buddy. Just wait till Andrew gets here and puts you in your place!

A car pulls up at the entrance. Everyone turns to look as Andrew steps out. Bowen shoves past Riley and rushes over.

BOWEN
Andrew! You're early. You shouldn't be opening your car door. You should have waited for me!
(to the others)
Bring the gifts!

Several employees carry in boxes of gifts.

BOWEN
(fawning)
I've prepared, specially for you, these Christmas gifts, plus a private lounge with some gourmet treats. Enjoy the celebration.

ANDREW
Good job, Bowen.

Andrew approaches Caroline, beaming with a smile.

ANDREW
Caroline, why did you come by yourself? I even stopped by your place to pick you up.

CAROLINE
Thank you, Andrew, but you didn't have to...

Andrew takes Caroline's hand. She recoils in shock.

ANDREW
It's OK, Caroline. I'm happy to do it for you.

Riley's expression stiffens. He pushes Andrew away and warns him firmly and accusingly.

RILEY
Get your filthy hands off her!

EPISODE 28

Andrew's face darkens as he glares at Riley.

ANDREW
Riley? You came with Caroline? This party is for the auto plant. You don't even work here. You really have no shame, do you?

CAROLINE
Riley is my husband! Family members are allowed here.

Andrew snorts in contempt.

ANDREW
Even if they are, there are standards! He's so broke, he's making this place dirty just by being here!

CAROLINE
Andrew!

ANDREW
Enough, Caroline. I'm sure Riley insisted on coming, and you didn't have the heart to say no. Let me handle this.
(to Riley)
Get lost. You don't belong at our Christmas party!

Riley remains cold, silent and still. Bowen tries to grab Riley by the shoulder.

BOWEN
You heard him! Andrew said beat it! A hobo like you shouldn't pollute the air in here!

Riley easily twists Bowen's arm, making him yelp in pain.

BOWEN
Let go, you jerk!

RILEY
Bowen, it's Christmas. I would hate to beat the shit out of you.

ANDREW
Just as I thought, a coarse, low-life thug. Riley, you're even worse than I imagined. Out of respect for Caroline, I won't have you arrested, but you need to leave now!

Riley releases Bowen, who winces in pain.

RILEY
You want me to leave? Your father wouldn't dare speak to me like that. Who do you think you are?

ANDREW
You need a reminder? This is Ravenham Auto Plant. I'm the head of R&D, and my father is the vice president. What about you? You're just a thief! No one here wants you around!

Employees begin whispering, giving Riley looks of disdain. Riley frowns.

EPISODE 29

WORKER 1
What's going on? Caroline's husband is a thief?

WORKER 2
If Andrew said so, it's gotta be true. Just look at him. He looks shady as hell. Gross!

Andrew looks pleased with himself. Riley glances around, his frown deepening. Caroline is frantic.

CAROLINE
Wait! Everyone, Riley isn't a thief!
(MORE)

CAROLINE (CONT'D)
(turns to Andrew)
Andrew, you've made a mistake, Riley—

BOWEN
Caroline, you're kind woman, I know that, but you shouldn't cover for your thief of a husband.

ANDREW
Exactly. I saw it with my own eyes. How could I be wrong? Caroline, you're too nice to expose him, but it's time to put a stop to his lies. Stop defending him!

RILEY
I'd love to know what exactly you think you saw.

ANDREW
Those gifts. Where'd you get them? Could you afford that stuff? If you've won the lottery, maybe. You know, I almost feel sorry for you. If there's anything you want at this party, just name it. You can take it home. Think of it as charity.

Riley grabs Andrew by the collar, his expression icy.

RILEY
Say that again?

BOWEN
Let go of him, son of a bitch!

ANDREW
It's OK, Bowen, I got it. You're so pathetic, you wanna hit me? You're nothing but a beggar, a thief. I said it, now what?

CAROLINE
Andrew! If you didn't want us here, you could've just said so. Why make it so unpleasant?
(tries to pull Riley away)
Forget it, Riley. Let's go home. We don't need to be here.

Caroline tries to make Riley let go, but he dodges her hand, keeping his grip on Andrew's collar. Caroline is stunned; Andrew glares at Riley.

RILEY
You know, I really gotta give it to fucking idiots like you. Trouble is about to rain down on you, and you're still strutting around like kings.

20. EXT. AUTO PLANT ENTRANCE - DAY

A car pulls up. Cody steps out with an air of arrogance, his bodyguard holding the door. Bob rushes forward to greet him with a fawning, kiss-ass smile.

BOB
Cody! You're here!

EPISODE 30

Cody keeps an air of nobleness as Bob comes greeting him, all smiles.

CODY
Good to see you, Bob. Let's start with going over your project proposal, then we can discuss our next steps after the party's started.

Bob can hardly contain his excitement.

BOB (V.O.)
From the way he's talking, this project is a sealed deal! If I can land it, I'll be the hero of the plant. With Wharton Group backing me up, I will finally take over as plant manager!

BOB
Absolutely, sir! Right this way!

Bob eagerly leads Cody into the plant.

21. INT. AUTO PLANT - EVENT HALL - DAY

Andrew shoves Riley's hand off his collar, and smooths it over as he talks angrily , his mean eyes fixed on Riley.

ANDREW
Trouble? For me?
(laughs)
I've never seen someone so stupid! You're the one in trouble, Rye. When my father gets here, you'll be on your knees, begging for mercy!

RILEY
You and your father are nothing to me.

ANDREW
You dare insult my father?

BOWEN
You idiot! You have no idea what Bob Smith means to Ravenham. You're a dead man walking!

CAROLINE
Riley! What are you doing? You need him to get you a job!

ANDREW
Oh, right! Caroline, thanks for reminding me. Your husband is a joke. It's Christmas, and he begged your dad to ask my father for a job! Ha! Riley, you're such an embarrassment!

The employees exchange awkward, disgusted glances. Caroline feels a mix of anger and shame.

RILEY
Honestly, if I tell you what I really do, you'll piss yourself.

ANDREW
Piss myself? Are you serious?

RILEY
Dead serious. If you don't want that to happen, I'm giving you one last chance.
(points to the floor)
Get on your knees. And apologize.

EPISODE 31

Caroline and Riley stand tense as Andrew, confused, bursts into laughter. Bowen joins in.

ANDREW
You want me to apologize? What do you do, Riley? Sell eggs? Wash dishes? Maybe you're just a bum! You're right, I am pissing myself, laughing!

BOWEN
Yeah, he's definitely scrubbing dishes at the Ritz today!

CAROLINE
Enough! Stop laughing at Riley! You're going too far!

ANDREW
(still laughing)
Caroline, your husband has one redeeming quality: he's hilarious! He always brings a good laugh!

CAROLINE
Andrew!

RILEY
Good. Remember every word you just said.

ANDREW
(still laughing)
What else do you have to say? Get out. Right now!

Riley scoffs and pulls out his phone, dials a number.

RILEY
(into phone)
I'm giving you one minute. Bring that idiot's dad, what's-his-name, Bob, in front of me. Now.

CUT TO:

22. INT. AUTO PLANT - MANUFACTURE AREA - DAY

Cody looks respectful as he speaks into the phone.

CODY
Yes, sir!

He hangs up and turns to Bob.

BOB
Jeez, who were you just talking to with that kind of respect? The chairman?

CODY
You'll find out soon enough.

BOB
What?

CODY
Let's go. We've seen enough of the project. We can discuss the rest at the party.

BOB
Of course, sir!

Bob follows Cody out.

23. INT. AUTO PLANT - EVENT HALL - DAY

Andrew glares at Riley, who tucks away his phone.

ANDREW
Who are you trying to impress with this act? What idiot's dad are you talking about?

RILEY
So you're not *entirely* stupid. You figured out who I meant.

ANDREW
You son of a—

Andrew swings at Riley, but Riley easily counters, sending Andrew crashing to the ground.

EPISODE 32

Caroline rushes to Riley, panicked, pulls him back.

CAROLINE
Riley! How could you hit Andrew? He'll never forgive you. You're in real trouble now!

ANDREW
You piece of trash! How dare you hit me! Riley Diaz, today I'm putting you in the ground!

CAROLINE
Wait!

ANDREW
Security! Get every guard in here now!

Six security guards quickly surround Riley.

RILEY
I overestimated you, Andrew. I thought you'd at least face me like a man, but you're just a coward.

ANDREW
Shut the fuck up. First, you steal Caroline, and now you disrespect me in front of everyone? I'm going to make you disappear for good!

Cody and Bob are rushing to the hall. Cody glances at his watch.

CODY
Ten seconds.

Riley sneers at Andrew.

RILEY
You talk a big game, Andrew. But be careful, I might actually make *you* disappear.

CAROLINE
Riley! Stop! You don't know how powerful his family is. You could really get killed!

Cody and Bob enter, looking grim.

RILEY
Killed?

ANDREW
Now you're scared, huh? Too late! Today, you're meeting your maker! And Caroline, you bitch, I'm done with you. After I take care of this loser, you better be waiting for me, naked and ready!

Riley's fury spikes. He grabs Andrew by the collar and gets in his face.

RILEY
Say one more word about Caroline. Go on. I'll let it slide when it's about me, but her—

Riley tightens his grip on Andrew's collar.

RILEY
I won't let you get away with it.

Andrew shakes off Riley's grip, seething.

ANDREW
Still trying to play the hero in front of Caroline, huh? Well, now I'll make sure you're dead!

Andrew grabs a gun from a guard's holster and points it at Riley.

CAROLINE
No!

Cody and Bob arrive, both shocked.

CODY
Stop!

EPISODE 33

24. INT. CAR FACTORY EVENT HALL - DAY

Everyone turns, stunned, to see Cody.

CODY
If you hurt Mr. Diaz, I swear you won't see tomorrow!

Andrew, snarling, aims the gun at Cody.

ANDREW
Who the hell are you? You think you can talk to me like that? Do you want to die?

BOB
Andrew, stop! Put the gun down now!

Andrew freezes, confused.

ANDREW
Dad? What are you doing here? Aren't you meeting the manager from the Wharton Group?

BOB
The manager of the Wharton Group is standing right in front of you, you idiot! Apologize to Mr. Brown right now!

Andrew's eyes widen in shock. He quickly lowers the gun, trying to smile at Cody.

ANDREW
Mr. Brown, I'm so sorry. I lost my head for a second.
(points at Riley)
This is all his fault. He was making a scene, and I just wanted to teach him a lesson!

CAROLINE
Sir, Riley wasn't causing any trouble. They were the ones bullying him—

BOB
Quiet, girl! Mr. Brown can judge for himself!
(MORE)

BOB (CONT'D)
(turns to Cody)
I'm so sorry that you had to see this, sir.
(gestures at Riley)
I'll have that man thrown out right away!

RILEY
Alright, Cody. I've had enough of their clown show. Aren't you going to stop them?

BOB
Watch your tone when you talk to Mr. Brown!

CAROLINE
No, sir, please! Riley's just upset. Please forgive him—

CODY
You don't have to explain, miss.

ANDREW
Caroline, begging Mr. Brown won't help. He's not gonna forgive your dumb ass husband.

Caroline looks worried. Riley, smiling, wraps an arm around her and pats her shoulder.

RILEY
It's alright, babe. He's only gonna be a dick for a little longer.

Caroline looks confused as Cody steps forward and bows respectfully to Riley and Caroline.

CODY
Miss, I'm not in any position to forgive Mr. Riley Diaz. Whatever he wants is my highest command!

Caroline is stunned. Bob and Andrew are left speechless.

EPISODE 34

Carolyn stands frozen, shocked.

CAROLINE
What? Sir, you must be mistaken.

ANDREW
Cody, you've got it wrong! This guy's a nobody! Why are you treating him like this?

BOB
Exactly, Mr. Brown! This is Riley Diaz, a man who can barely scrape together ten bucks!

BOWEN
He's nothing but a loser! Sir, he doesn't deserve your respect!

CODY
Shut up! You have no idea how important Mr. Daiz truly is!

ANDREW
What?

Cody approaches Riley, his demeanor respectful and slightly remorseful.

CODY
I'm terribly sorry, sir. I came too late, and these idiots dared disrespect you. I'll deal with them immediately!

ANDREW
Mr. Brown, you must be mistaken!

RILEY
You idiots still don't get it, do you? Soon enough, you'll be on your knees, begging for my forgiveness.

ANDREW
(furiously)
Shut up! Who do you think you are?

RILEY
Nothing much. Just someone who can fire you and take away everything you have.

Enraged, Andrew punches Riley on the face.

ANDREW
Bullshit! You think you can fire us? Keep dreaming, you worthless scum! Mr. Brown's just confused, that's all! Did you really believe you're someone important?

Cody, fuming, slaps Andrew hard.

CODY
You idiot! The "scum" you're talking about is the Chairman of the Wharton Group!

EPISODE 35

The room falls into stunned silence as everyone stares at Riley. Andrew stammers, a hand to his face.

ANDREW
C-Chairman?

BOB
Sir, you're saying this man who looks homeless is the Chairman of Wharton Corporation? That's impossible!

Caroline,staring at Riley in disbelief, lowers her voice to almost a whisper.

CAROLINE
Oh my God... Am I dreaming?

RILEY
Idiots, I warned you not to mess with me. I'm going to make sure you learn your lesson! Guards, take them!

The guards step forward, seizing Andrew and Bob.

ANDREW
Wait a second, you can't be the Chairman...

BOB
This can't be happening, it just can't! I refuse to believe it!

RILEY
You are dead man walking, believe *that*. Take them away!

Andrew breaks free from the guards and drops to his knees in front of Riley. Riley kicks him back, sending him to the floor. Mouth bleeding, whimpering, Andrew gets back up, begging.

ANDREW
Riley, man, I didn't know! I swear I didn't know you were the big boss! I'm a fucking idiot!

Riley stares at him unwaveringly.

RILEY
Who I am doesn't matter. What matters is you've been using the factory's name to boss people around acting all tough.
(MORE)

RILEY (CONT'D)
You've ruined its name! *And* you insulted Caroline!

ANDREW
I was wrong! Please, forgive me!

RILEY
It's too late. Here're your two options, you're fired, and I send you to the police and they make sure you pay for every crime you've committed. Or. My guys spend a little quality time with you.

BOB
No!

ANDREW
Riley, we've already apologized, why won't you just let us go?

Riley turns to his men in suits next to him.

RILEY
Take them to the dock. Kill the son slowly and make sure the dad watches every moment of it. Then kill him too.

The guards grab Andrew and Bob and drag them toward the exit.

ANDREW
No! No! Wait! I get it now! You're not really the Chairman! You're bullshitting!

The others turn to look at Andrew.

BOB
Andrew, what are you saying?

Andrew struggles against the guards, yells furiously.

ANDREW
Doris told me before that that man forged the Chairman's seal to get a car from the factory! I didn't realize how far this piece of shit would go!

EPISODE 36

Cody looks at Andrew, puzzled and annoyed.

CODY
What are you talking about?

Andrew storms over to Riley, pointing an accusing finger.

ANDREW
You all have no idea how twisted this guy is and how low he's stooped to!

Riley frowns as Andrew continues.

ANDREW
He forged the chairman's seal, pretending to be someone he's not! He's a con artist!

Bob freezes, then bursts out in anger.

BOB
Dear God! So that's it! You deserve to burn in hell!

Andrew glares at Cody.

ANDREW
Cody, we all know what this guy is. He's nothing but a filthy bum! There's no way he's a big shot in the Wharton Group! You've been duped!

Cody, furious, snaps back.

CODY
You need to shut up this instance!

Bob tries to calm Cody down.

BOB
Sir, I know it's hard to accept that, but he's at fault here, not you. I'll drag him to the police right now!

Andrew interrupts.

ANDREW
No! Not yet!
(points at Riley)
You lowlife! You tricked me into begging for mercy! Now, I'm gonna screw your wife right in front of you, and you're gonna feel what real despair is like!

Andrew grabs Caroline, who yelps in surprise.

CAROLINE
You bastard, let me go!

Andrew laughs lewdly.

ANDREW
Let you go? Sweetie, you should be thanking your idiot husband! His stupidity put you in this mess!

Caroline struggles desperately as Riley's face is ice cold.

RILEY
I'll give you one chance. Let go of her.

Andrew smirks, sneering at Riley.

ANDREW
I've figured out your little game. Just wait and watch as I put on a show with your bitch right here!

Riley‘s fury boils over, and he punches Andrew to the ground. He gets on top of Andrew, eyes murderous, as he raises his clenched fist.

RILEY
You know what, I changed my mind. I'm gonna clean you out myself.

EPISODE 37

25. INT. AUTO PLANT - EVENT HALL - DAY

Caroline stands nearby, stunned and numb. Andrew lies on the ground, shocked, staring up at Riley.

ANDREW
Shit! Let go of me you psycho!

Riley, scoffs, steps back, letting Andrew get up. Andrew, in pain, struggles to his feet and spits out blood to the floor.

ANDREW
I'm gonna smash your skull right here!

RILEY
If you still aren't gonna get on your knees and apologize to her, my mercenaries will blow your entire family to bits tonight!

Andrew laughs mockingly.

ANDREW
What a joke! You, with mercenaries? I'm the one who's gonna break your bones!

The two men charge at each other, fighting savagely, exchanging blows and punches. Caroline, frantic, tries to intervene.

CAROLINE
No, no! Stop! I'm going to get Farra!

Carolyn dashes out, terrified.

26. INT. FARRA'S OFFICE - DAY

Farra is reviewing documents, but she pauses, frowning in thought.

FARRA
(talking to herself)
Cody only told Bob he's coming here.... Why? Have I done something to upset the Group? Whatever, I should at least pay my respects to Cody.

Caroline bursts into the office, breathless. Farra looks up, startled and annoyed.

FARRA
Who is it? Can't you knock?
(smiles as she recognizes Carolyn)
Oh, hey, Caroline! What's going on?

CAROLINE
Mrs. Ewing, I'm so sorry for barging in, but you need to come quickly! My husband and Andrew are in a fight!

Farra freezes, stunned.

FARRA
Your husband? You mean Riley Diaz?

EPISODE 38

Carolyn nods quickly, desperation in her eyes.

CAROLINE
Yes! My husband Riley is fighting Andrew! Please, you have to stop them!

Farra slams the documents down on her desk in anger.

FARRA
For god's sake! Why can't he give it a rest!

CAROLINE
I know Riley is wrong, but he was only trying to defend me. Please, Ms. Ewing...

Farra, fuming, rises from her chair.

FARRA
That idiot! Dammit! He's completely lost it! This entire plant could go under because of him!

Caroline is shocked.

CAROLINE
Go under? Ms. Ewing, it can't be that serious!

Farra, rushing out, throws a glance over her shoulder. Caroline hurries after her.

FARRA
I'm going to check it out now. But I need this financial report sorted before the welcome dinner. Can you handle that?

Caroline eyes the stack of papers, hesitant but resigned.

CAROLINE
Alright, Ms. Ewing. Just... please, don't be too hard on Riley!

Farra hurries out, leaving Caroline anxiously watching her.

27. INT. AUTO PLANT - EVENT HALL - DAY

Riley lands a punch on Andrew's face, making him cry out in pain as Riley pins him to the ground. Andrew looks to the security guard.

ANDREW
Dammit! Aren't you going to help me? Do you really think he's the boss? If you don't help me right now, you're all fired!

The security guards exchange uncertain looks but move in to pull Riley away. Andrew gets to his feet, brushing the dirt off his clothes.

ANDREW
You scumbag! Your wife's probably running to get Farra. Just wait! She's the only one of us who's met the chairman!
(MORE)

ANDREW (CONT'D)
And she's gonna take no shit from you! You'll be dragged into court for impersonation!

Bob seethes with rage.

BOB
Farra probably will inform the real chairman and let him deal with you himself! You'll lose everything. Maybe even end up dead, you pathetic insect!

Bowen joins in, glaring at Riley.

BOWEN
Clown! Prepare to die! You've had your chance to beg for mercy!

Riley glares back, unfazed.

RILEY
Is that so? I can't wait to see what Farra's gonna do! And you are about to realize just how badly you've screwed up!

Farra, looking tense, is rushing toward the event hall.

EPISODE 39

Andrew smirks in defiance, rage filling his voice.

ANDREW
You still think we fucked up? You're delusional, Riley. You have no idea how much shit you're in. When Farra gets here, your little charade is over.

BOB
It won't matter how much your wife begs. Farra's never been one to listen to excuses. She won't forgive you either.

Cody glares at them.

CODY
You all must be out of your minds! You think I can't recognize my own boss? Like I need your factory manager to confirm his identity?

Andrew, suppressing his anger, turns respectfully to Cody.

ANDREW
Sir, it's not your fault. This scumbag is a master conman. He even fooled you. But don't worry, we'll handle this fraud. No one will ever know you mistook him for the real chairman.

Cody throws up his hands, laughs an angry laughter.

CODY
God, what am I even doing here? Alright, let's see what *Farra* has to say when she gets here.

Meanwhile, Farra is hurrying to the event room, anxiously checking her watch.

ANDREW
What will she say?
(pointing at Riley)
She's going to tear into this imposter and make sure he's dragged in front of the real chairman for a proper punishment.

Riley snickers. Andrew turns to him.

ANDREW
What's so funny, Riley? Losing your mind? Beg me, and I might just put in a good word for you. But of course, Caroline would be mine.

RILEY
Don't get it twisted, Andrew. I'm laughing because you've already got one foot in the grave.

ANDREW
What did you say?

RILEY
You don't need to understand what I'm saying. Just start thinking about your last words.

EPISODE 40

Andrew kicks at Riley which he adroitly dodges.

ANDREW
Fuck you! Still got something to say? Fine, I'll just break both your legs and see how cocky you are then!

CODY
Enough!

RILEY
These fuckers are as good as dead.

BOB
Shut up! Put your hand on my son and acting all smug and shit. Congrats, Riley, you've officially pissed me off.

Andrew picks up his gun again.

ANDREW
Save it, dad. I'll teach him a lesson right now. First, I'll break his legs, then his arms. After I've made him suffer enough, I'll blow his head off.

CODY
I can't watch this anymore!

Cody moves to grab the gun, but Bob steps in front of him, staring at him coldly.

BOB
Mr. Brown, you don't want people finding out you mistook someone for the chairman, do you? We're just giving this impostor what he deserves. Don't get in our way.

ANDREW
That's right. Don't stop us from doing the right thing, or we might think you're in on it with him.

CODY
(laughs)
You're beyond saving!

Andrew points the gun at Riley, who meets his gaze coldly.

ANDREW
(mad and triumphant)
What's the matter? Weren't you just telling me to think about my last words? Seems like you're the one who should be saying goodbye now!

RILEY
Your stupidity never disappoints me, Andrew.

ANDREW
Still yapping away. Fine, die, Riley!

Andrew cocks the gun, barrel right at Riley's unwavering head. Farra rushes in, seeing this scene, shocked.

FARRA
(furious)
Andrew, stop! You idiot, have you lost your mind?

EPISODE 41

Farra strides in and angrily knocks the gun out of Andrew's hand.

ANDREW
Ms. Ewing! You're here? What are you doing?

BOWEN
Ms. Ewing,
(points at Riley)
This scumbag was throwing hands at my son and me. You need to deal with him!

Bob hurries over to Farra.

BOB
That's right, Ms. Ewing! What did Caroline say to you? Her husband is pretending to be the chairman of the Wharton Group! He even stole a car and fooled Mr. Brown!

ANDREW
Exactly! He's not just a fraud, he attacked me! He's a terrorist, ruining our Christmas party! You should drag him in front of the boss and let him deal with this!

FARRA
Shut up, you idiots!

BOB
What? Farrah, how could you talk to us like that? I may be just the deputy manager, but Cody called me directly to arrange this visit. I think...

Farra coldly glares at Bob, then turns to Riley with a respectful bow.

FARRA
I'm sorry, Chairman. I got here too late. I was reviewing the accounts, and I had no idea someone would dare to disrespect you like this!

Riley remains calm and arrogant. The employees are shocked.

BOB
What?

BOWEN
So he *is* the Chairman?

ANDREW
Ma'am, did you just call him Chairman, too?

RILEY
Farra, if you hadn't arrived when you did, I wouldn't have witnessed such a wonderful performance. This factory has managed to breed so many corrupt and power-abusing parasites.
(points at Bowen)
Even an idiot like him can be a researcher! I think it's time for some major housecleaning around this place!

EPISODE 42

Bob, in shock, stares at Riley.

BOB
How could you be the Chairman?

Farra strides forward and slaps Bob hard across the face.

FARRA
You idiot! You've put us all in a huge mess! Don't you know the entire Raveham Auto Plant depends on Wharton Group's investment? One word from Mr. Diaz, it could all be taken away!

ANDREW
Ms. Ewing, he must've fooled you too! He forged the Chairman's seal and tricked everyone! You can't fall into his trap!

Farra slaps Andrew, knocking some sense into him.

FARRA
You think anybody can just forge the Chairman's seal? It's made with special techniques! Plus, the Wharton Group website updates with the latest directives from the Chairman! Check and see if the car request is there!

Andrew quickly pulls out his phone and frantically scrolls. His face goes pale.

ANDREW
It's there... it's really there! He's really...

Riley watches them, smirking with pride.

RILEY
That's right. And soon, the website will be updated again, with the news that you and your father have been fired, and arrested. Or do you wanna make it on the obituary instead?

ANDREW
Mr. Diaz!

Bowen, panicked, tries to slip away, but Riley's icy gaze catches him.

RILEY
Where do you think you're going, Bowen?

BOWEN
S- Sir, it's all a big misunderstanding!

RILEY
Oh, I think you understood just fine.

Riley signals to his guard, who hands him a gun. He takes it and aims it at Bowen.

BOWEN
Please, don't! Forgive me!

Bowen, his eyes shut, his hands cover his ears. Sweating, he gets on his knees and mutters a prayer. Riley sighs, shaking his head.

RILEY
No one is answering your dumb prayer but me. And frankly, I'm just not impressed.

He pulls the trigger. Nothing comes out but an empty CLICK. Bowen screams desperately, shaking even more as he is on the floor in a fetal position. When he opens his eyes, he finds himself unharmed. Riley snorts with contempt as he hands the gun to his man without taking his eyes off Bowen.

RILEY
Every man acts tough until there's a gun pointing at him. Then he starts crying for mama. Pathetic.

He turns to Farra.

RILEY
Farra, audit all three of them. Every project, every account. I don't want a single penny unaccounted for, you hear me?

FARRA
Yes, Chairman.

RILEY
You've let this factory turn into a shit storm. You should be punished too, but considering you've taken care of Caroline, I'm gonna let it slide. Now, go audit those two and don't show your face until you've finished.

FARRA
Yes, thank you, Mr. Diaz, for giving me another chance.

Riley turns his cold stare back to Bob and Andrew, who are frozen with fear.

BOB
R-Riley—no, Chairman...

ANDREW
I was wrong! I never should have gone near Caroline, never should have disrespected you... Please, have mercy!

EPISODE 43

Riley stares them down, towering over their shaking bodies, and smiles.

RILEY
What? We're just checking your work. No need to be this scared. Unless you're hiding something? How much of the factory's money have you stolen?

BOB
We were desperate... We.. couldn't even keep the lights on so we thought...

ANDREW
Yeah! We're never stepping on your toes again, we swear!

Riley snorts in disdain.

RILEY
I gave you plenty of chances, and you managed to waste every one of them. Sending you to the cops is way too easy on you.

Riley closes in on Andrew, plants one hard punch to his head, and then another. Andrew is out cold, blood dripping down his chin. Riley turns to Bob.

RILEY
You wanna bury him yourself, or do I bury both of you next to each other?

28. INT. FARRA'S OFFICE - DAY

Caroline is packing up documents when her phone buzzes. She quickly answers the video call.

CAROLINE
Hi, Demi. What's going on?

Demi, sitting in a car, grins at the screen.

DEMI
Caroline! You won't believe it! I went back to change, and when I got to the plant, I bumped into Farra and the Chairman! And guess what? I talked my way into being his driver to the welcome dinner!

Caroline forces a smile, clearly preoccupied.

CAROLINE
That's great, Demi. Good luck.

Demi looks concerned.

DEMI
What's wrong, Caroline? You seem stressed.

CAROLINE
I'm worried about my husband. He got into a fight with Andrew, and I don't know how Farra handled it. I'm gonna make a call and find out.

Demi looks puzzled but nods.

DEMI
Alright, Caroline. Oh, and I'll sneak a photo of the Chairman later. You have to see how hot he is!

EPISODE 44

Caroline freezes, staring at the screen.

CAROLINE
A photo?

DEMI
Yeah, Caroline! I'll see if I can get a good shot in!

Caroline sighs, shaking her head.

CAROLINE
The banquet is about to start. You don't need to sneak around—I'll see him soon enough.

29. EXT. OUTSIDE THE AUTO PLANT - DAY

Riley's man opens the car door for Riley, who gets in. Half of Riley's body appears in Demi's video call before she ends it in a hurry.

DEMI
The Chairman's here. I've got to go.

The call ends, and Caroline stares at the blank screen, still processing. She sighs.

CAROLINE
This girl... she's falling hard. I'd better call Riley and see how he's doing.

30. INT. CAR - DAY

Riley sits in the car while Farra and Cody stand outside, looking at Riley through the window.

CODY
Sir, I didn't have a chance to mention this, but my nephew Kurt works in the Corporate's Administrative Department as the Deputy Director. He was on vacation in Philadelphia, but when he heard about your banquet, he rushed back this morning.

Riley smiles.

RILEY
I get it, Cody. I'll keep an eye on the young man for the director's promotion.

Cody beams.

CODY
Thank you, sir! Oh, and since Farra needs to audit Bob and his son, she‘s handed over the banquet arrangements to me. Here's your personal entrance card.

He hands Riley a card, who tucks it away.

RILEY
Good. And if any of my wife's family shows up, let them in.

CODY
No problem, sir. I'll confirm the guest list right away.

Farra and Cody head off as Riley's phone rings.

CAROLINE (VOICE OVER)
Riley, are you alright?

Riley, pleasantly surprised, answers.

RILEY
I was just about to call you. It's all taken care of. I'm waiting for you outside the plant. Oh, you're helping Farra with the audit? I can wait. It's no problem.

Demi watches him curiously. He hangs up and looks up at Demi, smiles.

RILEY
I think I'll wait for my wife and we'll head to the banquet together. No need to drive me.

Demi pauses, a little disappointed.

DEMI
Alright, sir. See you at the banquet.

31. EXT. OUTSIDE THE AUTO PLANT - DAY

Riley steps out of the car. Demi drives off. He waits by the road when Doris, Cornell, and KURT approach. Riley is surprised.

RILEY
Doris, Cornell, what are you doing here?

DORIS
Don’t get the wrong idea. We're not here for you. It's Kurt. He hasn't seen Caroline in a while and was dying to catch up with her.

Riley looks curiously at Kurt.

RILEY
Kurt?

KURT
Yeah, that's me. I used to be Caroline's neighbor. So you are Caroline's husband? Man, you look even more pathetic than I imagined.

EPISODE 45

32. EXT. AUTO FACTORY - DAY

Riley frowns, staring down Kurt.

RILEY
So, it really is you, Kurt. I'd suggest you keep it cool if you want any chances at that promotion.

KURT
How do you know about that?

DORIS
Don't listen to him, Kurt. Ever since he got back, he's been spewing nonsense like he's lost his mind.

KURT
Well, that makes sense. My reputation precedes me, even to someone like him. Everyone knows I'm the top candidate for the position in the finance department.

Riley chuckles derisively.

KURT
Riley, Doris told me a lot about you. Apparently you're a nobody. Since Caroline married you, you were never able to make her happy.

RILEY
You don't know the first thing about being happy. Only I can make Caroline truly happy. Why don't you ask her yourself?

KURT
Sure thing, bud. Doris was right. You've lost it. Let me tell you what happiness is: money and power. Sadly, you've got neither. You don't deserve Caroline!

RILEY
And you do?

CORNELL
Enough, Riley. You don't wanna cross Kurt. You're not even in the same league as him.

KURT
Exactly. Cornell gets it. I'm leagues above you. If you had any sense, you'd leave Caroline and let me take care of her.

RILEY
Kurt, stop pushing it, it's Christmas. Or my gifts to you is gonna be some ass whooping.

Kurt hesitates for a moment, then laughs mockingly.

KURT
You gonna whoop me? You're a joke! I could crush you with one finger!

Riley suddenly slaps Kurt across the face. Doris gasps and steps back, shocked. Kurt clutches his cheek, stunned.

KURT
You son of a bitch hit me!

Riley slaps him again, harder.

RILEY
Sorry, couldn't help it. Your face looks too inviting. Consider it my gift to you.

Caroline rushes in, wide-eyed with disbelief.

CAROLINE
Riley! Did you just hit him?

EPISODE 46

Doris glares at Riley, seething.

DORIS
You son of a bitch! You've ruined everything! First Andrew, now Kurt. What the hell is wrong with you?

CORNELL
I was gonna ask Kurt to help you find a job, and you blew it again, Riley! Can you do anything right?

Caroline hurries over to Kurt, checking his face.

CAROLINE
Kurt, are you okay?

KURT
Your husband needs mental help. You should seriously think about leaving him before he does something really bad.

CAROLINE
He didn't mean to, Kurt. I'm so sorry.

RILEY
Caroline, don't apologize. He insulted me first!

DORIS
Riley, shut up! So what if he said some stuff? You don't deserve Caroline. He's right about that!

CAROLINE
Mom! You're not helping!

KURT
Enough! No more apologies! Caroline, I got a little surprise for you. You're gonna love it.
(MORE)

KURT (CONT'D)
It'll show you how much better I am than your loser husband.

CAROLINE
What're you talking about?

KURT
Tonight is the CEO welcome banquet. Only top executives and the elite of Ravenham can attend. Last time I checked, Caroline, you're just a factory worker. I assume you weren't invited.

CAROLINE
Well, I was promoted today, so I'm allowed to go now, I guess.

KURT
Oh, well, good for you. But you still can't bring Doris and Cornell along. However,
(pulls out an invitation)
It's a VIP pass from the Wharton Consortium. With this, you can take your family with you.

Caroline and the others light up, surprised and excited.

EPISODE 47

33. EXT. OUTSIDE THE AUTO PLANT - DAY

Doris beams with excitement.

DORIS
That's amazing, Kurt! You know how much it would mean to us to attend the CEO's banquet!

CORNELL
It's a dream come true! Kurt, my man, you just made my year!

CAROLINE
Thank you so much, Kurt. Doris and Cornell have been dying to go. This really means a lot.

Doris reaches out to grab the invitation, but Kurt quickly pulls it back. Riley watches this, frowning. He pulls out the card Cody gave him, glancing at it, then back at Kurt.

DORIS
Kurt?

KURT
You want this pass? Sure. But there's a catch.

DORIS
What? What is it?

KURT
Caroline needs to be my date for the banquet. She'll go with me.

Caroline hesitates, caught off guard.

RILEY
No! Caroline is my wife. She is not going with you.

KURT
You're a nobody, Riley. You're not even invited. Why are you even talking right now?

CAROLINE
But Kurt, this isn't right...

Doris grabs onto Caroline's arm.

DORIS
What isn't right!? Riley can't go anyway. You're just his date, and you and Kurt go way back. What's the harm?

Riley, growing increasingly frustrated, pulls out his card.

RILEY
Doris, I can get in! Caroline, I need to tell you the truth. The thing is, I'm actually—

DORIS
The thing is, you're a dumbass! What even is that thing? You think flashing some random card is going to get you into the banquet?

RILEY
Doris, listen to me—

DORIS
No, you listen! Kurt is with the Wharton Group's finance department. His uncle is a manager there! It's an honor for Caroline to be his date. It's a huge opportunity for all of us! We'll finally get the respect we deserve in Ravenham!

EPISODE 48

34. EXT. AUTO FACTORY - DAY

Caroline, anxious and worried, tries to reason with Doris.

CAROLINE
Doris, Riley is right. It's really not appropriate for me to go with Kurt. I'm married...

DORIS
Don't listen to this loser! You and Kurt are perfect together! It's settled. Let's get you a new dress. As Kurt's date, you're gonna be the star of the evening!

Doris drags a reluctant Carolyn away. Carolyn looks back at Riley, clearly distressed.

DORIS
And you, Diaz! Just stay home and keep dreaming, you worthless bum!

Caroline turns to Riley while being dragged away, and shows him a reassuring smile.

CAROLINE
Don't worry, Riley! David and Tessa will be there. Remember them? Our old friends? I'll stay close to them, I promise!

Dories keeps pulling her impatiently.

DORIS
Stop talking to him, Carolyn! Let's go!

Carolyn, pulled away, glances back anxiously. Kurt throws a smug look at Riley before following them. Cornell awkwardly pats Riley's shoulder and walks off.

Riley watches them leave, a bitter and cold smile on his face.

RILEY
That pass only gets one person in. The only reason they're getting in tonight is because I arranged it with Cody. Fine. Don't believe me. Tonight, I'll give you all a real surprise.

35. INT. WELCOME BANQUET - NIGHT

Festive evening, with a sparkling Christmas tree at the center, colorful streamers, and large bows decorating the windows and walls. The buffet tables are adorned with Santa hats, Christmas bells, and other festive trinkets. Christmas music fills the air.

TESSA BENNETT(27) approaches DAVID BALL (27), holding a glass of wine. She smiles and clinks glasses with him.

TESSA
Merry Christmas, David. I knew I'd see you here. You're Wharton's finance guy in Ravenham, after all.

DAVID
Of course, Tessa. Merry Christmas! Looks like you're doing pretty well with the Wharton Guild. Just a couple more years before you make it into the Consortium for real.

TESSA
Tonight's banquet is for the successful few. Looks like we're the cream of the crop from our class. But where's Bowen? I thought he was a foreman at the factory. Didn't expect him to miss this.

DAVID
Who knows? Maybe he didn't make the cut.

Riley walks in, his expression cold and detached. David spots him and nudges Tessa, sneering.

DAVID
Well, look who it is. Our old classmate Riley. Top of the class, but bottom of the barrel now.

TESSA
Oh my God, is he still in between jobs? How did he get in here?

David and Tessa exchange a look, then approach Riley. Tessa pretends to accidentally spills her wine on Riley. He flinches, frowning as he tries to wipe the wine off.

TESSA
Oops! My bad. Oh, Riley? How did you, of all people, get in here?

EPISODE 49

Riley keeps wiping his clothes, clearly annoyed.

DAVID
Riley, Tessa's talking to you! Are you deaf?

RILEY
I'm not deaf. But first, you owe me the money for dry cleaning.

Tessa is momentarily caught off guard, then laughs mockingly.

TESSA
Typical of a broke guy to quibble over dry cleaning. Anyway, how'd you even get in here?

RILEY
I just walked right in. Want me to do it again and show you?

TESSA
Stop acting all high and mighty. We know what kind of low-life you are. You don't belong at the CEO welcome banquet.

DAVID
I saw Caroline's parents come in earlier. You probably sneaked in with them. Kurt said everyone in Carolyn's family could get in except you.

Riley chuckles coldly.

RILEY
If I'm not here, this banquet won't even be worth holding.

TESSA
Seriously? What does this have to do with you? Listen, for old time's sake, just leave, before everyone here laughs you out of the room.

Doris, Cornell, Heidi, and Nick enter the banquet, excitedly looking around. They spot Riley and walk over, surprised.

DORIS
You again? We finally get to attend this fancy banquet, and you have to show up and ruin it?

HEIDI
I knew it! If Caroline doesn't leave you, you're going to drag us all down!

NICK
Kurt's not here yet, so get lost, you piece of trash, before you embarrass us all.

RILEY
The only reason you Bakers got in here is because of me. And now you're trying to kick me out? Who gave you the right?

EPISODE 50

36. INT. WELCOME BANQUET - NIGHT

Heidi pauses, then bursts into laughter.

HEIDI
Did y'all hear that? This guy thinks we're here because of him!

NICK
I don't even know what to say, Riley. Everyone knows we're here because Kurt gave us the invitation. What's that got to do with you?

DORIS
I've really had it with you, Riley!

DAVID
Riley, stop making a fool of yourself. We all know you're broke. Why you gotta keep pretending?

TESSA
If I'd known, I would've skipped last week's circus. Watching you is entertainment enough!

RILEY
You do realize the banquet starts in ten minutes, right?

TESSA
Yeah, so? You're gonna humiliate yourself in front of the CEO?

Riley smirks,confident and composed.

RILEY
No, in ten minutes, you'll be on your knees begging me. This floor's going to see a lot of tears.

TESSA
You bastard! How dare you!

NICK
This is a high-class event! Losers like you shouldn't even be here. Where's the hotel security? Get this man out of here!

CARL, the hotel security chief, approaches, looking down at Riley with disdain.

CARL
Kid, this is Wharton Hotel, owned by the Wharton Group. Causing trouble here is a death wish.

RILEY
You're the head of security here?

CARL
That's right. You've offended our VIP guests, so I'll give you one chance to crawl out of here.

Riley chuckles, still cold and detached.

RILEY
What did you say?

Carl points to the ground, his tone condescending.

CARL
I said crawl! You idiot, do I need to show you how?

EPISODE 51

37. INT. CAR - NIGHT

Caroline and Kurt sit together in the car. Caroline is anxiously checking her phone.

CAROLINE
Doris just texted me. Riley showed up at the banquet! And it sounds like he's in trouble.

Kurt sneers dismissively.

KURT
That loser probably snuck in somehow. This is the CEO's welcome banquet, and he's in there being a dick? He's in real trouble now.

Caroline looks at him, panic in her eyes.

CAROLINE
What should we do? Kurt, can you help him?

Kurt smirks, sliding his arm around Caroline's waist. She flinches, pulling away.

38. INT. WELCOME BANQUET - NIGHT

Riley sneers.

RILEY
Go ahead, show me how to crawl out of here. Lead by example.

CARL
What the fuck you say? Looks like I'm gonna teach you a lesson!

Carl charges at Riley, but Riley swiftly punches him, sending him back. Carl stumbles, shocked, clutching his face. Riley calmly takes out a handkerchief and wipes his hand.

RILEY
A lot of people seem to be asking for an ass beating today.

CARL
Do you even know who I am?

RILEY
I could give a shit about who you are, buddy. But you've got me wondering. Why does Wharton Group have so many idiots working for them? Maybe I should review our management policies.

Doris storms over, furious.

DORIS
You idiot! Shut up already! You hit Carl and ruined the banquet. Nobody's going to save you now!

RILEY
I don't need saving. It's you who should be worried.

Carl gets up, his face twisted in anger.

CARL
You're a dead man walking!
(yells to his men)
Guys! Get over here and throw this piece of shit out. Beat him to a pulp if you have to!

The security team rushes in, closing in on Riley.

EPISODE 52

39. INT. CAR - NIGHT

Kurt's face is filled with anger and irritation. He reaches for Caroline's hand, but she quickly pulls away.

CAROLINE
Kurt! Please, don't do this. I'm married.

KURT
I know that. But your husband is a nobody. Why do you even care? And let's not forget, you asked me to help Riley. Which I'm happy to do. I can also get him a job. You just gotta meet my terms.

CAROLINE
(scared)
I can pay you, but...

KURT
No, Caroline. I want you.

Kurt leans in. Caroline is stunned, gripping her hands tightly in fear. Caroline glances out the window and bolts out of the car.

KURT
Caroline!
(punches the steering wheel)
Damn it! What a bitch!

He gets out the car and chases after her.

40. INT. WELCOME PARTY - NIGHT

A security guard lunges at Riley, but Riley swiftly grabs his arm and floors him.

RILEY
Last chance. If you keep pushing me, I won't forgive a single one of you.

HEIDI
Oh, what a clown! No one believes your nonsense! Stop it already!

DAVID
We're all high-ranking employees of the Wharton Group, and you're talking to us like that? Boy, you've got a death wish!

TESSA
When you die, I'll bring a bottle of piss to pour on your grave!

Another guard charges at Riley, ready to strike. Caroline rushes into the room, panic-stricken.

CAROLINE
Stop! Stop! Don't hurt him!

Riley catches the guard's incoming punch, pins him to the ground, and looks up at Caroline, flashes a smile.

EPISODE 53

41. INT. WELCOME PARTY - NIGHT

Caroline freezes, then runs to Riley.

RILEY
I'm so sorry for letting you worried about me, babe.

Caroline checks Riley's body for injuries.

CAROLINE
Riley! As long as you're not hurt... Doris said something happened at the party. What's going on?

Kurt strides in, exuding arrogance.

KURT
There you are, Caroline!

Everyone turns to look as Kurt approaches.

CARL
Kurt! You're here! Someone's causing trouble at the welcome party!

David points at Riley.

DAVID
It's this piece of shit! He's not just causing trouble; he insulted us and got physical!
(MORE)

DAVID (CONT'D)
As a high-level employee of Wharton Group, you're the only one who deal with him. Don't let this cocksucker off easy!

HEIDI
And don't worry about his connection to Caroline. We all want nothing to do with this loser. Punish him as he deserves!

Kurt stops in front of Riley, arms crossed, full of arrogance.

KURT
You parasite, I never thought you'd really show up here.

RILEY
No one has more right to be here than I do. If I want to, I can kick every last one of you out.

Kurt chuckles, glancing at Caroline.

KURT
Caroline, you see this? Your husband is nothing but a violent, lying-ass clown!

CAROLINE
Kurt, please don't say that.

KURT
All I gotta do is stand here next to him. I don't even gotta say shit, you can see who's superior. I'm the Vice Minister of Wharton Administration! My uncle is the manager of Wharton Group! And he's just a broke, attention thirsty bitch-ass clown!

Caroline frowns, shaking her head.

RILEY
Kurt, keep talking, and you won't only lose your job. You'll drag your uncle down with you too.

KURT
What the fuck you say to me?

Kurt grabs Caroline's hand, and she looks at Riley in panic.

KURT
Let me be clear. You are as good as dead. You don't deserve Caroline! She will divorce you and run straight into my arms!

EPISODE 54

Caroline is frantic as Riley, cold and angry, shoves Kurt away.

RILEY
If you lay a finger on Caroline again, I will rip your head off and put it on display in the middle of this party!

KURT
Bullshit! Who's going to listen to you?

Kurt forcefully grabs Caroline by the waist. She looks at Riley in desperation.

KURT
I'm telling you right now, Caroline is mine! You're such a failure you can't even keep your wife. I wouldn't even let you lick my shoes, bitch!

Riley slowly walks over to Kurt, who seems unperturbed, then he headbutts Kurt hard, knocking him back a couple of steps. The crowd gasps.

RILEY
So Jack Reacher is right. No one expects a headbutt. What were you saying about Caroline?

KURT
You filthy stray dog!

NICK
You have any idea who he is? You're in way over your head!

DAVID
You idiot!

Riley grabs Kurt by the collar, lifts him up till his feet leave the ground, as he glares at him.

RILEY
I said, tell me again. Who does Caroline belong to?

Caroline grabs Riley's hand, anxious.

CAROLINE
Riley, calm down! You can't afford to hurt him. If he wants to make things difficult for you, you won't stand a chance!

Kurt glances at Caroline, then sneers at Riley.

KURT
Caroline's got more sense. You want me to say it again? Fine, I will! Caroline is mine! Your wife is my mistress! You're nothing but a broke, powerless loser!

Riley, enraged, throws Kurt to the ground and fires two shots into the floor. The crowd screams, and Kurt stares in shock and fear.

EPISODE 55

42. INT. WELCOME PARTY - NIGHT

DORIS
(hysterical)
Riley! What are you doing?

TESSA
You've lost your mind!

DAVID
I can't believe you really brought a gun in here! It's the chairman's banquet!

Kurt, terrified, scrambles to his feet, pointing at Riley.

KURT
You're a fucking terrorist! I'm calling the cops! I'm gonna have you thrown in jail! You're finished!

The security team moves in, surrounding Riley.

CAROLINE
(panicked, in tears)
No! No! Riley, you've made a huge mistake. You're gonna be in jail, and the chairman of Wharton Group will punish you. What are we going to do, Riley? Why're you so reckless...

DORIS
Caroline! What are you doing? Get away from him! He's a criminal!

Caroline, tearfully, looks at Doris and shakes her head.

CAROLINE
Mom! I'm not going anywhere!

Riley, moved, tightly grips Caroline's hand and gazes at her.

RILEY
Caroline.

Caroline tearfully gazes at him, who gazes back at her gently and full of affection.

RILEY
Thank you for always being with me, for waiting, for supporting me. Meeting you has been the greatest fortune of my life.

Caroline, tears running down her face, sobs as her eyes stay fixed on Riley.

CAROLINE
No, don't say things like that.

TESSA
(mocking)
Finally saying your goodbyes?

Riley glances dismissively at Tessa, then looks back at Caroline, smiling.

RILEY
Do you trust me, Caroline?

Caroline, trails of tear on her face, stares wide-eyed.

CAROLINE
What?

Riley tightens his grip on her hand.

RILEY
These people are so cocky. I can make them go way right now. All I need is one kiss from you.

EPISODE 56

Caroline stares at Riley in shock, her face a mix of confusion and disbelief.

DORIS
You've got to be kidding me! Riley, I didn't think you could get any more ridiculous, but here you are, proving me wrong. I have to respect that!

DAVID
Don't ever tell anyone we were classmates. I'd hate for my reputation to take a hit.

Riley gives them a cold look before turning his attention back to Caroline.

RILEY
So, what do you say, Caroline? Want to give it a try?

CAROLINE
Riley, this isn't the time for jokes.

RILEY
I'm not joking, sweetheart.

Riley leans in and kisses Caroline briefly, catching her by surprise.

RILEY
There, I've got what I wanted. Now, it's time for the show.

CAROLINE
What're you talking about!?

Riley steps forward, his demeanor turning arrogant as he faces the others.

KURT
You son of a bitch! You kissed her right in front of me? I swear I'll kill you for this! Just wait!

RILEY
Oh really, Kurt? I'm afraid you won't get the chance.

KURT
Bullshit!

Riley strides confidently, his arrogance palpable as he counts off on his fingers.

RILEY
Let’s see... Vice President of the Wharton Group, representative of the Ravenham branch, a senior member of the Wharton Finance...
(stops in front of Carl)
Oh, and you, Captain of the Wharton Hotel Security Team.

TESSA
Are you listing the people you've pissed off? Too bad for you, it sounds like you're not getting out of this party alive.

RILEY
Quite the opposite, Tessa.

Everyone stares coldly at Riley.

RILEY
This entire welcome party is for me! I could have all of you thrown out right now if I want to!

The group is momentarily stunned before they burst into laughter.

KURT
I thought you had something worthwhile to say! How pathetic! You can't even tell a good lie! Are you saying you're the guest of honor at this party? That you're the Chairman? And that when I put my arm around Caroline, I was touching the Chairman's wife?

Caroline looks dazed.

RILEY
That's right. You've made an unforgivable mistake, and it's going to cost you everything.

DORIS
Oh, enough with the bullshit! Stop making a fool of yourself! Haven't you embarrassed yourself enough?

EPISODE 57

DORIS
You snuck into this party without permission, and we were willing to let that slide. But you didn’t stop there. You caused a big scene, attacked Carl and Kurt, and now you've got the balls to claim you're the Chairman of Wharton Group?

Heidi, David, and the others look at Riley with disdain. Riley shakes his head, exasperated.

DORIS
You should be in a mental institute! If I had known you'd turn out like this, I would've done everything in my power to stop Caroline from marrying you!

Riley checks his watch, seemingly unconcerned.

RILEY
The party is about to start, so where is everyone?

Doris freezes, caught off guard. Riley pulls out his phone and makes a call, his tone arrogant.

RILEY
(into phone)
Cody, get over here now! If you're not here in five minutes, don't bother showing up at all!

43. INT. CORRIDOR - NIGHT

Cody is walking in a hurry, while talking panicked on the phone..

CODY
Yes, sir! I'll be there right away!

Cody hangs up, his face pale with worry and anxiety.

CODY
Why did Riley sound so mad? Did I do something wrong?

He picks up the pace.

44. INT. WELCOME PARTY - NIGHT

Doris snatches Riley's phone and throws it to the ground.

CAROLINE
Doris! What are you doing?

DORIS
Don't you get it, Caroline? He's still lying! He's pretending to be the Chairman, and he just disrespected Cody in front of everyone!

Kurt steps forward, laughing scornfully.

KURT
Listen, if you were trying to fool anyone else, maybe it wouldn't be so pathetic. But you're doing all this crap in front of me? You're nothing but a clown! Do you even know who Cody is? He's the manager of Wharton Group, and he's my uncle!

Cody arrives, rushing into the scene. Riley and Kurt stand face to face, the tension thick. Riley stands with his arms crossed.

RILEY
Oh, is that right? And what's that supposed to mean? That I should be scared of you?

Kurt points to the ground.

KURT
Of course! You should be on your knees right now, begging for my forgiveness like the pathetic worm you are!

Cody rushes in, stunned by Kurt's words.

CODY
You idiot! Who the hell do you think you're talking to?

EPISODE 58

45. INT. WELCOME PARTY - NIGHT

Everyone stares in shock. Kurt is momentarily stunned but then excitedly steps forward.

KURT
Uncle, you're here! Everyone, this is Cody, the manager of the Wharton Group, and my uncle!

DORIS
Merry Christmas, Cody!

DAVID
Merry Christmas, sir! Cheers!

Everyone, including Tessa, gives a respectful bow. Cody surveys the room, his gaze lands on Riley, then back to Kurt.

CODY
What happened here? You didn't cause any trouble, did you?

KURT
Of course not! I was just putting a clown in his place!

CODY
Clown?

KURT
(points at Riley)
Yeah, him! He's been causing trouble at the chairman's welcome party, and get this, he even claimed he's the chairman of Wharton Group! He pretended to call you, too! Can you believe this trash? What a joke!

Cody's eyes widen in shock, a look of fear creeps over his face.

RILEY
Cody, take care of it.

KURT
How dare you disrespect my uncle? You're dead, you hear me? I'll kill you, and your wife Caroline will be all mine!

Cody's hand trembles before he suddenly punches Kurt hard, making him stagger back. Everyone is stunned.

KURT
Uncle, what'd you do that for? You should be punishing *him*, not me!

CODY
Riley Diaz is the chairman of Wharton Group, you idiot!

Kurt is frozen in disbelief.

EPISODE 59

Kurt clutches his hurting face, staring at Cody in shock.

KURT
Uncle, did I hear that right?
(points at Riley)
This piece of shit? He's just a loser who went unemployed, a rat living in the sewers! How could he possibly be the chairman of Wharton Group?

Cody punches him again, busting his nose.

CODY
Shut up, idiot! Do you think I couldn't tell who the chairman is?

Kurt collapses to the ground, unable to believe what he's hearing. Doris and Heidi exchange incredulous glances. Caroline stares at Riley in shock. He smiles back at her.

RILEY
Sorry I had to break it to you this way.

CAROLINE
So...all this time, my husband is the most powerful man of the state...and I had no idea?

RILEY
Guilty as charged. Had to convince a couple idiots the hard way but...glad it's out in the open.

Cody approaches Riley, bows deeply, voice trembles with guilt.

CODY
I'm so sorry, Mr. Diaz! I had no idea Kurt would be so disrespectful. I'll have him out of the Corporation immediately! And his whole family out of Ravenham.

Kurt, scared out of his wit, holds onto Cody's leg.

KURT
No! How can you do this to me? I'm your nephew!

Cody kicks him away.

CODY
Not anymore! I don't want anything to do with you!

Kurt turns to Riley, terrified.

KURT
How...how can you be the chairman? It's impossible...

Riley steps up to Kurt, stares squarely into his eyes.

RILEY
I can ruin your life and everything you've worked for at a snap of my finger. I can wipe out your whole family tree like you never existed. You wanna try me?

Kurt scrambles backward on the floor, terrified. Riley's man picks him up roughly and tosses him to a corner, kicking him as he crawls desperately in vain.

KURT
No, no, I didn't know who you were. Please, sir, forgive me! I won't do it again. I beg you!

Riley paces around the room, making everyone uneasy. David, Heidi, and the others tremble as they watch him.

RILEY
David, Tessa, we're old friends. I could've helped you in your careers, but you were blinded by money and power! I saw how you're obsessed, how you treat poor people like dirt!

DAVID
Riley, we...

TESSA
We were stupid! We're still old friends, please forgive us!

RILEY
Doris, Heidi, Nick... you're my family. I used to trust you, but you bullied me, knocked me down for a little power, even tried to make Caroline leave me for someone else!

DORIS
(frightened)
Riley, that was... *so* wrong of us to behave like that...

Heidi nods along in a hurry, also scared out of her wits as she stutters.

HEIDI
Y-yeah... we never imagined you'd be the...chairman. Why didn't you tell us?

RILEY
If I did, how would I be able to see your true, ugly faces? Now, you idiots, it's time to face the consequences of your actions!

46. INT. WELCOME PARTY - NIGHT

HEIDI
No! No!

Caroline rushes forward, grabbing Riley's arm.

CAROLINE
Riley, they're still my family. Please don't make things too hard for them!

RILEY
Caroline.

He turns back to Doris and the others, coldly.

RILEY
Fine, you all owe my wife a big thank you. I'm done dealing with pests like you. Just don't show your ugly ass faces in Ravenham ever again.

DORIS
We won't! Never! Riley, you're my son-in-law. You and Caroline are the perfect couple!

Riley steps up to Kurt, who is on the floor, whimpering in pain.

RILEY
We're just getting started with you. Take him away.

Carl steps forward, all humbled and eager to please.

CARL
Yes, sir!
(to the security)
Take him away!

Riley puts an arm in front of Carl, stopping him.

RILEY
Oh, I almost forgot. You, the head of Wharton Hotel security. You're fired! And you got ten seconds to get out of my hotel.

CARL
What? No, Mr. Diaz!

Riley takes out his gun and loads it.

RILEY
Nine. Eight. Seven...

Carl dashes for the door. Riley watches him, almost bored. Then he says out loud.

RILEY
One.

Riley pulls the trigger at Carl's feet. Carl hops around, trying to dodge. Then he makes it to the door and stumbles out. Riley puts the gun away, scoffing.

Demi rushes in, confused by the scene, and runs up to Carolyn.

DEMI
Carolyn, what happened here? Listen, I had the worst luck today! Someone scraped my car, and I had to take care of it, so I'm late! Did you see the chairman? By the way, I heard your loser husband crashed the welcome party. Where is he? I'm going to give him a piece of my mind!

Riley steps up, smiling. Demi waves at him, pleasantly surprised.

DEMI
Mr. Chairman! So good to see you again, and Merry Christmas! Welcome to Ravenham!

RILEY
(smiles)
Merry Christmas, Demi. Caroline's told me a lot about you.

DEMI
Caroline?

Demi looks at Caroline, who smiles back.

RILEY
Actually, I'm Caroline's loser husband.

DEMI
What?

CAROLINE
(awkward)
I just found out too. Riley is the chairman of Wharton Group!

DEMI
You're Caroline's husband of three years?
(MORE)

DEMI (CONT'D)
(points at Carolyn, shocked)
And you're the wife the chairman traveled all the way home to spend Christmas with?

Riley wraps an arm around Carolyn's shoulders. They exchange smiles and nod at Demi, whose face is painfully distorted out of shock.

DEMI
Oh My God...

Riley and Carolyn gaze at each other. Riley gently wraps an arm around her shoulders.

RILEY
My love, these three years I've been so preoccupied with work, I never got the time to be with you. Everyone looked down on me, laughed at me, but you never left. You're always there, standing by me.

Doris and the others are touched. Caroline is overwhelmed by love and joy.

CAROLINE
Riley, I can't believe it. This all feels like a dream.

RILEY
It's not. Merry Christmas, Caroline. From now on, we'll celebrate every Christmas together!

Carolyn smiles and nods. Riley kisses her as everyone applauds and cheers, raising their glasses.

EVERYONE
Merry Christmas!

THE END